

DOORWAYS TO LIGHT



GURUJI KRISHNANANDA

"We must know about certain truths."

"There was a life before this. There will be a life after this. We do not die with the physical body. We survive in our Astral bodies."

"There are other planes; other dimensions. There are people living there like us; not the little green men of the science fiction. They are much more intelligent; much more civilised and much more advanced in all sciences. They are also very good, kind and loving. They can help us a lot in this and the next lives."

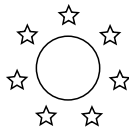
"The Rishis are not just the characters in Puranas. They do exist. Some are here on this earth and many are in the higher planes. They are a part of a huge network of Light Beings who work under the Cosmic Intelligence. They can be contacted by anyone astrally and receive guidance and help."

(Page 140)

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Doorways to Light

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I had named this book as "**The Unknown Life of the Unseen Lights**".

One day, Amara mind-linked with me and said: "It is too long. Name it as the **"Doorways to Light"**".

—Guruji Krishnananda

A NOTE

For years, I wanted to write this book. I tried several times and even wrote a part, once. But the book did not materialise.

One day, recently, I noticed the shortened candle of my life and then decided to bring it out; a part of it at least.

Over the years, the book had grown, shrunk and had changed a lot. It had also grown complex with many incredible things. I had a problem - what to write and what not to write.

* * *

This book is about my Guru, Amara. But an essential part of my life is also intertwined here. And also that of those Light Beings in the higher planes, known to us as the Rishis.

This is more about the unknown life of the unseen lights.

1-2-1998

—Guruji Krishnananda

ANOTHER NOTE

Eight years have passed since the book came out in print first. I am glad that it has touched so many hearts and has opened new doorways. Almost every reader, after reading the book, has spoken immediately or written to me with excitement and wonder for more information on the Rishis and Astral worlds. What strikes me as a singular approach is that even the most educated and the scientific tempered have accepted the existence of the Rishis (Light Beings), the Pralaya (Transition) processes and the advent of Satya Yuga (Light Age) *intuitively*.

I resisted the strong advice that the book be professionally edited and freshly presented. I wanted to retain the rusticity without any clinical freshness.

May more doorways be opened and more Light shine in the world.

November 16, 2006

—Guruji Krishnananda

PART ONE

ONE

This is no fiction. But some events here may appear stranger than fiction. And I do not intend convincing anyone.

What is real?

When I look down from the higher planes, all these appear so unreal. When I go still higher up, everything disappears in the vastness. Light alone shines still higher up there. The Light was there all the time. I had not noticed it. And I thought I had seen everything!

I had relied too much on this infant science and blind logic. I did not know that there was a higher science; truths beyond logic. I did not know many things. That was before I met Amara.

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I met Amara in 1977. It was a cool February evening in Bangalore when I walked into his house with my friend. We waited in the neatly furnished drawing room for a few minutes. A strongly built man in his fifties moved in majestically and smiled gently. It was Amara!

I had composed myself to meet a person with a flowing beard and hanging beads. But Amara was entirely different. He looked like a professor, in his neatly pressed shirt and trousers. But there was something very big about him that I could not grasp at that time. After the introductions, Amara asked me:

"So, you want to meditate?"

I nodded.

His voice was rich, soft and intimate. He smiled and stared at me for a long time. I could not read him and I was aware that he was probing me deeply. I was also aware that something was surfacing in me; a hazy memory; a warm feeling. I told him that he looked very familiar.

He smiled again, as he spoke.

"We have met earlier."

"No! This is the first time that I am meeting you!"

"We have met in the past lives."

I did not know how to react. I would have laughed at anyone else. But he sounded so genuine and sincere! I waited for him to continue. But he remained silent. Perhaps, he did not want to elaborate. It was enough to speak the truth. It needed no explanation. He asked me to meet him the next day. As we were leaving, he said:

"The Rishis will initiate you. I will fix up an appointment with them."

Appointment with the Rishis! My friend had, of course, briefed me earlier. Amara was in contact with the Sapta Rishis, the seven great Masters, the Hierarchy, in the higher planes. He would meet them daily during nights travelling in his Astral body and would participate in the works related to human welfare and evolution.

Will the Rishis come tomorrow? Will I be able to see them? I was thrilled with anticipation and let my imagination go wild as we stepped out into the noisy street and the cold world that appeared strange and different now.

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I had made several unguided attempts to meditate after reading books. I realised soon that books were webs of interesting theories but had little practical guidance, after we take a few unsure steps. A guru was necessary. I was searching for one.

I was with Amara the next day at the appointed hour. He led me to a room upstairs. It was full of incense smoke. There were big idols and huge mirrors. There was an intimate quietude and a Divine atmosphere. I looked around quickly as Amara smiled.

"No. You cannot see the Rishi who is here now. He is in his Astral body."

I glanced around again quickly without expecting to see the Rishi. He must have been there! The place was vibrant with a Divine presence. I could touch him mentally.

I sat down in front of Amara and waited.

Amara gave me very clear instructions about Meditation, after explaining it briefly.

"Meditation is silencing. We silence the entire system - body, mind and intellect - gradually. In silence, many inner processes begin. First, the system gets cleansed. Then it is prepared to go through higher experiences which will eventually transform us into higher beings. We will be gradually linked to our Source and receive all knowledge about ourselves, this creation, birth, death etc., directly."

"Is Meditation concentration?" I asked.

"No. It is beyond concentration. It is a journey in Consciousness as we advance."

"But I have read in books...."

"I know....there are many distortions. But my Knowledge is

from the Rishis. It is they who taught humanity Meditations in the beginning, thousands of years ago. They are the original Masters. I will explain more later. Now, close your eyes and fix your gaze at your mid-brow point. The Rishi here will charge you with Spiritual energy, initiating you into Meditation."

I closed my eyes, fixed my gaze and waited. Then I felt a wave of energy, descending on me and then, I lost my consciousness. When I opened my eyes, Amara smiled. And one hour had passed!

I went home dazed but with a very pleasant state of mind. Thus, my journey in Consciousness began.

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"I had my first Astral Travel when I was around ten."

Amara spoke in his usual unhurried way as I sat before him in his Meditation room, consciously allowing every word to imprint itself on my mind, knowing very well that I was receiving an unknown treasure.

I began meeting Amara regularly on Friday evenings as suggested by him. I would wait all the week for this precious hour with him. He would check up and guide my Meditations and pass on rare knowledge that thousands of years of Tapas would not have helped me gather. He explained things not found in books and gave me the whole science of Meditation! One day, after a long time, he said "Now you can add a new chapter to Patanjali's Yoga Sutras!"

Amara also narrated some of his works with the Rishis and his experiences, during the Friday hours. One day he narrated his first contact with the Rishis.

"I was undergoing an operation. I was administered anaesthesia and was asked to count ten. I counted upto six and then lost consciousness. I lost my body consciousness but was aware of another level of existence which I learnt as the Astral, later on."

"I felt I could move within my body and also could come out. I came out through a dark passage. It happened without any effort. Just a wish and I was out!"

"Then I saw my own body from above, surrounded by the doctor and others. It was then that I heard a strange music from a far away place. I wanted to go there and immediately I began moving at a fantastic speed. I came out through the roof and journeyed in space. I saw the city behind, shrinking fast to a point before I realised that I was moving out of our earth's field. The music was coming from a still higher place in space. Strangely, I did not feel scared. All this was so exciting!"

"Our earth looked like a big moon. I zoomed past the Moon, Venus and Mercury in the dark expanding space. Finally, I reached the Sun and went in! After passing through the bright and burning surface, I entered a blue space within the Sun. I could see several earths and the music was coming from the central earth. I landed on that earth in a big city."

"There was a huge building in the centre. Many people were moving in and out of it. I too went in forgetting the music which appeared to have stopped suddenly. As I entered a huge hall, I saw a very handsome person wearing a crown, sitting on a dazzling throne. People were bowing before him. I too bowed. Then I felt hand on my shoulder. I turned and saw a familiar face!"

"What are you doing here?"

"I explained. He said that he was a friend in my past life and that I should not have come there before death! As he was leading me out of the hall, I asked him about the person on the throne. He told me that he was Lord Suryanarayana, the Sun-God! I felt a thrill all over."

"We moved out into an open area with several tent-like structures. We entered one and there we found Seven Rishis seated around a tall well-built Rishi. My friend whispered that he was Vishwamitra Maharshi and those around him were the Sapta Rishis - Bhrgu, Atri, Angirasa, Vasishta, Pulastya, Pulaha and Kratu Maharshis. My friend explained to them about me. Vishwamitra Maharshi stared at me for a while and spoke with great love and understanding:

"It is good that you have come here and seen all this. But now, you have to go back to your body in your earth."

"I did not want to return! I liked that place and wanted to stay there. The Rishi smiled and said:

"Who would not like to stay here! But you have to go back. Go back. I will come and meet you there."

"I could not resist him. He appeared so magnificent! Like a god! Reluctantly, I came out and returned back. As I was descending down through the roof, I could see the doctor and others staring down at my body. I slipped into my body easily as if I had done it many times earlier. When I opened my eyes, all those around me beamed with joyful relief. They must have concluded that I would not stir again!"

"After this, I waited for days and months for the Rishi. He did not come. When I spoke about my journey to others, no one took me seriously. My people joked and laughed. As months passed, I began to console myself that it was all just a dream."

"Then, one moonlit night, I was looking into the sky through the window, when I saw a star moving. In a few moments it entered my room and stood before me! It was not a dream. Then I heard a voice: "I had promised to visit you. I have come. Are you ready to see me?" I uttered a feeble 'yes' and waited."

"First it was a hazy form. Then it took a solid shape. In less than a minute, Vishwamitra Maharshi materialised. It was sudden and unbelievable. I cried. He took me into his arms and held me for a long beautiful moment."

"Then he spoke: "It was I who called you there with the music. Now I have come to prepare you for our work. I will come every night to teach you everything about Yoga and Spirituality. Is it alright?"

"I could just nod my head. Thus began my learning and training that lasted for nearly two and a half years. He taught me Pranayama, Meditation, entering deep Samadhi and coming out of it, raising the Kundalini, Astral travel, materialising, multiplying the body, the secrets of Samyama and many other secrets. Then, one night, he took me astrally to a secret place in the Himalayas where the Rishis gather every night. There was a huge gathering. To a Rishi seated on a platform, he presented me saying, "I have brought you a young Rishi. Take him for work."

"As I bowed, he said: "This is Markandeya Maharshi, in charge of our works now!"

"I could not believe it. He looked like a young man. He was in his physical body, not in the Astral! What could be his age! Must be thousands of years!"

"What is his name?"-asked Markandeya Maharshi. Vishwamitra Maharshi replied: "From now on he will be called Amara." Thus I got my name and I am known as Amara in all the

Astral planes."

"Are you working even now?" I asked Amara.

"Yes."

"How many are working with you?"

"1,44,000. They are spread all over the world, living in different cultures."

"Do you know where they are living?"

"Yes. But we do not contact the others on the human plane."

"What is the work you do?"

"Someday, you will know!"

"Can I also join the work?"

"Amara smiled and said: "First, master the techniques of Meditation."

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Amara was Ambarisha Varma Desai of the Kaujalagi royal family. He was born in Bangalore in 1919 in the house where Sir C. V. Raman lived, later on. He studied in Bangalore and then in Madras for a degree in Science. He did not work for his living at any time. His people were very rich. When the land reforms were introduced they lost most of their lands and property.

Amara was married and had a daughter. His only brother had died young.

Once, he was considered for the position of an Ambassador which he declined, to continue his work with the Rishis, both on this physical plane and the Astral.

I do not have more details about him. He always spoke about his work, the Rishis, Meditation and about the rare Spiritual

Knowledge that he gathered along with the Rishis but he spoke rarely about himself. For me, his Spiritual part was more fascinating.

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Meditation was not easy. It was harder than I had expected. First, it was the pain in the knee joints. Then the thoughts, waves of them, bursting against the thin wall of silence. And then the mind, ever engaged in aimless pursuits. I was disheartened soon.

Amara led me step by step, holding my hand, guiding and encouraging. Now, looking back, I realise how difficult it must have been for him! Patience and Love were part of his Divine nature. He explained that all those obstacles that were pushing me back were a part of the process. They were all natural blocks. I had to cross them like every other beginner - failing, struggling, learning and moving on. Steadfast adherence and unrelenting efforts had no substitutes. I tried and tried and made progress gradually.

One day, Amara taught me the technique of Astral travel and said - "Come to our place in the Himalayas, tonight!" I could not contain my excitement the whole day. In the night, before going to bed, I practised the technique and waited to come out of my body as Amara did! But nothing happened. I waited and waited, as excitement gave way to shadows of disappointment and as darkness thickened, I dozed off. As I woke up, I tried to recall the night's venture. It was all blank.

Amara smiled at my failure. He always had a smile of understanding. He always understood us. He explained: "Astral travel is not easy. Separation of the Astral body from the physical is the first difficulty. You have to prepare yourself the whole day, from the morning. You should not allow your mind to get agitated in any

way. Remember, it is the mind that takes you. The mind is like a vehicle. You should not eat heavy food. This comes in the way of separation. From the morning, you should be thinking of your destination. This will build up sufficient thought-force to take you there. But the most difficult part is in recalling your Astral travel, the next day. With the help of the Rishis, you will definitely come out of the body and travel. You have to take my word for it. Even when you cannot recall anything, remember, you will have travelled! I will teach you how to recall easily."

I tried hard practising all that he taught. Even then, it was very difficult to recall my Astral travels which somehow I knew I had made. And sometimes, I had a few glimpses that penetrated the unconscious. They gave me thrills. After sometime, I learnt how to travel astrally to the place of my choice and also could recall the details. Then Amara cautioned me that I should use such faculties only for Spiritual purposes as instructed by the Rishis.

One day, he called me to the pooja room and said: "Tonight, we are invited to a very special place. Get ready."

It was a place under the sea!

"How can we go there?"

"The Astral body is a subtle body. It is not limited or affected by the five elements, the Pancha Bhootas. It can pass through water, fire or a wall."

I prepared myself for this exciting journey with great care following all the instructions.

I could not sleep for a long time and the worry began growing. At that stage, I could travel astrally only during sleep but a Master like my Guru could travel when he was awake. I spent an uneasy hour in bed and then something very strange happened! I was out

of my body somehow and was suddenly in the dark space outside! I could see nothing but was moving at a fantastic speed. It was only for a few seconds and then I stopped. I was aware, although I could not see, that I was hovering over the dark restless sea. I could hear the waves and feel the breeze! I felt a bit scared.

But I was not alone. Although I was enveloped by the darkness, I knew, somehow, that Amara was by my side. There were others too, whom I could not recognise. Amara had gathered several Meditators who used to come to him like me. We must have been hovering above for about a minute. Then we went down. It was like a flash! Suddenly, we were under the ocean! I tried to capture many times, later on, the details of my unbelievable journey into the deep dark waters. But nothing came to light; not even a glimpse of the virtual dive.

It was all dark, down under. But there was no water around us; no sea! It was as if we were in a bubble! I looked above. It was again darkness. I somehow knew that the sea was there, above the dark space. But could not understand what held it there. Amara explained later on that it was an energy field. We were in a hemisphere built by a very special energy. During the day, we could see the dim sunlight filtering through the very thick sheet of the ocean.

"This is Lanka!"

Amara explained, as we began moving towards a palatial building illumined by thousands of lights at a distance that we could see now.

"This is the Lanka of the great Ravana; the real Lanka. It was a very beautiful city with the most advanced civilisation. Rama did not want to destroy it. He invoked great powers from his Divine Source to sink it slowly under the ocean and preserve all life there.

It was thousands of years ago. Ravana's descendants are still ruling here. Vibheeshana lives here. He comes above whenever he wishes in a special submarine-like ship."

"Have you met him?"

"Yes."

"Have you come here earlier?"

"Yes. A number of times!"

A host of exciting questions were crowding in me. But we had already reached the place and a tall kingly person was greeting Amara with great reverence and intimate familiarity.

We entered a very huge hall and were conducted to throne-like chairs. I recognised Markandeya Maharshi already seated there. I also recognised some other faces of our Meditators. As we occupied the seats, a young lady dazzling with light, entered the hall and was escorted to a prominent place. Amara whispered:

"This is Padmavathy. She will marry Lord Kalki who is in Shambala now."

I turned to look at her. The light that was emanating from her engulfed me. In a moment, there was light all around. I saw nothing else and did not hear anything further. It was as if the light had enveloped my consciousness and I knew nothing more. When I woke up, it was morning. I tried to recall more from my night's venture but faced a blank wall. I waited till the evening to meet Amara and know more. The evening appeared to be days away!

There were several others around him in the evening. Each had at least some glimpse to recall. Each one narrated his part. All bits fitted into a single pattern. Amara explained the parts that we had not seen.

“Lord Kalki was born in 1924. He lives in his physical body in Shambala, a city of Light Beings, somewhere in the Gobi desert. This is a city of eternal youth. He is being trained by the Rishis for the work of the Great Change, the Pralaya. He is the one the world is waiting for, to deliver us from this dark age to the Golden Age. Yesterday was his birthday. It is celebrated in Lanka every year. He comes there astrally. Rishis and other Light Beings from other earths also come there astrally. You were fortunate to be allowed to visit.”

“We could not remember all. Is it deliberately erased by the Rishis or is it that we could remember only that much?”

“Both are true. Some persons could not recollect more and some parts were not allowed to be registered. They are secrets at present.”

“Who is Padmavathy?”

“It is a very long story. I will tell you at some other time.”

I did not mention about these to anyone. I could not. No one would have believed me. I had not even mentioned about my Meditations and Amara to others. First I wanted to explore the world of Amara by myself. I realised that he carried hidden treasures and hidden worlds.

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I must stop here and explain a bit. It may not make all this wholly credible but may suggest, I hope, that I am in my senses and this is not my unchecked imagination. At least, then, I can go on without pausing again.

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We were poor and that forced me into a shell of loneliness. But it helped me cultivate my inner life. I read a lot - Shaw, Maugham, Lawrence, Huxley, Russel, Eliot, Camus, Kafka, Sartre and others; wrote some short stories and poems too and even wrote a film script for a friend! I studied Kannada literature deeply and closely followed the Navya wave. I wrote several novels and short stories in Kannada. I could not find publishers in the beginning and when I could, I was reluctant to publish. I wanted to bring out better works.

I painted from my boyhood. Without the constraints of formal training, I could freely venture and develop my own form and line. I gave up painting to earn for the family when my father died young. Marriage eased the burden of finance slightly as my wife was also employed. I was working in the Telegraphs department.

My inner world of creative processes remained locked in. I had no one to share with. A few friends talked and debated the passing interests of the time. No one listened. No one suspected that I too carried dreams and visions within. Initially, I hoped that someday, I

would bring these to life in words and forms. But as life drew away my youth and years, I lived on without this rainbow of hope. I realised eventually that living itself was joyful enough! Keeping the creative processes alive within was more important than their physicalisation for others.

Books, films, music - my world was full. I helplessly watched the outside world being exploited and devastated by the forces of unashamed selfishness and greed for power, the value system getting destroyed and the freedom this country achieved after unparalleled peaceful Spiritual struggle being abused. I lost hope in tomorrow's order and justice. I had no faith in God. It was then that I went to meet Sai Baba, by chance.

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One day, I accompanied my wife to Whitefield for the Darshan of Sai Baba. My wife was a devotee. She used to speak highly of his materialising articles out of thin air. I wanted to see this miracle. I went there out of sheer curiosity without knowing anything about him.

It was almost evening when Sai Baba came out of his building to the big crowd, gathered under a huge tree, singing Bhajans. I watched the rise in the devotional fervour as he moved amongst the excited crowd. Then he did it! He moved his hand in circles a few times, closed his fist suddenly and then gave an elderly man Vibhuti, the holy ash. The crowd went delirious. I could not understand how he did it. I just wondered!

After an hour, Sai Baba went back to his building and the crowd began to disperse. Then I heard someone speaking to me. No, not physically but mentally! It was clear and loud!

"This is nothing. There are bigger wonders and unknown truths."

Was it Sai Baba? It must have been him! I knew, somehow, that it was he! I wanted to hear more; know more.

I read all the books about Sai Baba. I joined the Bhajans. I went to Puttaparthi, prayed for an interview with him and waited for days with crowds. Sai Baba did not speak to me.

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There was an old man near my house. The Bhajan groups would sing in his house three times a week. He kept huge photos of Sai Baba in his room. Vibhuti used to pour out of these. Sometimes, honey would trickle down. These were no tricks. And Kuppanna, the old man, was an honest man. I witnessed all these but waited for something more that I could not define then.

The Bhajan sessions were uplifting. The devotees were many. I found in the devotees, ups and highs during these periods of gathering but when I met them outside, I was disappointed to notice the continued ordinary-ness: the same anger, jealousy and all other common emotions; the same ways and attitudes. Their undoubted devotion and Bhajans had not brought lasting changes.

I was looking for something beyond the glamour of miracles, a way to live and grow. One day, after a Bhajan session, a friend asked me - "Do you want to learn Meditation?" I said, "Yes." He took me to Amara.

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I have often heard people talking about the scientific temper. They would proclaim that what we see is true; what is proven by

experiment is scientific. They would also declare that belief in God, after-life, soul, miracles etc., is unscientific. They would not accept these. I believe that accepting anything blindly is unscientific but rejecting everything blindly is also unscientific.

Can we declare all that is not yet known to us as non-existent? In that case, where is the scope for inquiry? Without inquiry, how can we know the unknown? How can science progress? There is also another angle. Can science explain everything? Can we experiment on a laboratory table and declare that there is God or there is no God? What about those Masters, the Rishis, who had known greater truths by their intuition and special faculties without the aid of laboratories and probing instruments?

Science begins with inquiry and never stops inquiring. A real scientist accepts the limitations of the laboratories, the physical tools of perception and their capabilities of comprehension. Denying and rejecting the now-inexplicable truths is unscientific. We have to keep an open-minded inquiry always sharp and alive and take up the appropriate tools of perception -the psychic and the other inner tools to probe into the unknown worlds.

Everyone will not just sit idle in the mansions of established facts. Some venture out searching for new lights in the unexplored areas of creation. They are guided by their own lights of intuition and other faculties. They experiment in the laboratories of the mind and deeper layers of Consciousness. They perceive new truths and enrich the human life. They may not write new theses for doctorates and may not be recognised for academic awards. But as Time moves on, civilizations will take strides in their footsteps.

We have to accept the truths discovered by the Masters of both the sciences - the Material and the Spiritual.

Amara was a Spiritual Scientist. He had the developed special faculties like the Third eye, Astral travel, entry into other dimensions, communicating with the Light Beings in any corner of the Cosmos from here and several other faculties. He had also reached the highest point in Spirituality from where he could directly commune with God. He was not a mere psychic or a man with unusual capabilities. He had also realised God. He was a Master like Ramakrishna Paramahansa, Ramana or Aurobindo. And yet, he lived like a normal human being in the sea of life. He laughed, joked, enjoyed cricket, drove a car, appreciated good literature, good films and classical music. First human, then Divine - he would always insist. He lived a very sensible and mature life. He was undoubtedly a perfect Being; a great Master. He would remind us often:

"Don't think all the special faculties are superfluous for the life that we are leading here. They are our innate capabilities. We have lost touch with them. With these, we can understand the realities of birth and death, the temporariness of this life and the necessity of outgrowing all our limitations to attain the final freedom that we have vaguely understood as Moksha. Remember, Spirituality is more of this life than the next as is totally misunderstood."

I do not know if many understood him fully. I doubt. People listened to the narrations of his Astral ventures which were highly fascinating and most wonderful. But few gave attention to his teachings or revelations from his association with the other Rishis in the higher planes. If the people had understood Amara, they would not have come to him with the horoscopes of their

daughters to know when they would get married! Amara was not fortune-teller! Amara would laugh sometimes and say:

"The higher faculties are not for the individual's use like this. They are for understanding the higher truths and when we understand them, it is easy to find solutions for our individual problems by ourselves."

Around 1930, he had predicted that this country would get freedom in 1947 and that Mahatma Gandhi would be shot dead in 1948. No one took him seriously then. They laughed and forgot him till the events occurred. He knew everything like a great Rishi. And yet, when someone asked once, if he could get the job he had applied for, he answered: "I don't know!" He explained to us, later on, that it was necessary for that individual to go through the experience of an interview and waiting.

"Every experience teaches us something. We learn the lessons of life through experiences. We should not interfere with the individual's learning process."

But I had also witnessed him answering such questions sometimes. Then, he explained:

"If a person is very weak and about to collapse, we have to help him! We cannot follow only one law. There are others!"

I knew he always helped.

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We accept everything from the West - from Shakespeare to jeans, from Marxism to Madonna. We accepted Vivekananda and Patanjali after the West approved them as great! I wonder, sometimes, if we are just shadows! When I speak of Astral Travel and other planes, our intellegentsia look at me with suspicion, as if

I have a twisted imagination! But I find, in the West, many individuals and groups speak of Astral experiences, energies, New Age, the Saviour and many other things. I am very happy about this because, someday, I hope to find myself acceptable here also! I am also in contact with some of the enlightened workers of the New Age. Soluntra King from Australia is one of them.

Soluntra is an amazing person. She was born with special faculties like clairvoyance, Astral communication etc. She has gone around the world several times, activating the energy centres lying dormant from hundreds and thousands of years and anchoring energies received from the Cosmos on special occasions like eclipses and planetary conjunctions. She visited me in 1995, on her way to Kashmir where she worked along with her small group to anchor special energies for peace and spiritually activating the place. In 1996, she came again to stay for a longer period when we could understand each other's work better and also build bridges. Soluntra is the only person with whom I could communicate wholly and travel astrally to different planes. There is someone to say that I am not insane!

This is the land of Rishis and Yoga. Many enlightened Masters have walked on this land of Aryabhatta and Patanjali. Vivekananda, Ramakrishna Paramahansa, Aurobindo, Ramana Maharshi and many other Masters lived and taught here. And yet, we who live in this land of temples and Ashramas, would not have accepted Edgar Cayce if he had taken birth here. If Pranic healing and Reiki had not come from outside, we would have derided them. But they are raging fashions now!

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Amara did not bother about how others received him. He was like a sun shining.

He always spoke gently without dramatising events that were uncommon, as if they were the daily common occurrences like going to work or talking to friends. Whenever we asked, "What happened yesterday?", he would narrate without any hesitation, his going to the Himalayas to meet Markandeya Maharshi; taking instructions from him about the work; then going to another earth in a different galaxy, meeting people there and bringing back information or about his meeting an angel once, on his way to a star, who was curiously looking down on our earth and exclaiming to Amara: "Now that these human beings have sent their first satellite, what will they do next? In the last cycle, they fought and destroyed each other with nuclear weapons. This time?"

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It was 1977; the day after Shivaratri. As I entered Amara's pooja room, I encountered a stunning sight. There was Vibhuti all over - on the walls, on the ceiling, everywhere. I had seen the manifestation of Vibhuti on Sai Baba's photos many times but not like this - not in this quantity and not over an area like this! The entire room was filled with an ethereal fragrance. Amara explained as we sat down for the weekly training-hour:

"The Sapta Rishis were here yesterday. We all worshiped Lord Shiva. This is a blessing."

I sat dumbfounded as he continued.

"Do not get carried away by these. These are mere signs. The ocean parted for Moses; the dead rose when Jesus called; Markandeya Maharshi crossed over the moment of death....behind these events lies the Grace and Love of God. We have to recognise Him behind all these."

Amara paused for a moment closing his eyes, perhaps lost in an

expanded moment with God. Then he spoke with such sincerity and reverence that I had not come across in anyone.

"We have lost most of the knowledge about ourselves and the Creation. What remains in the Vedas and other holy Scriptures is only a tiny part and cannot explain everything. But more and more knowledge will be gathered again by those that are awakening now. Now, the humanity is going through a very difficult phase of Pralaya which is totally misunderstood as destruction. Pralaya is Transformation; the Spiritual awakening. Once this phase is over, man will grow to his full potential which is nothing less than the Divine. Then we will have all the knowledge and power. Today, I will brief you about our origin and descent. Remember, there are many other details. This is only a glimpse."

"Imagine two pyramids, one standing on the other which is upside down. The base of the first pyramid sits on the base of the inverted pyramid. The space in between these two pyramids is called the Material Cosmos, the Brahmanda. It contains millions and millions of galaxies. This egg shaped space is very huge, having a diameter of eighteen billion light years."

"Each galaxy contains millions and millions of stars or suns. Each sun has a planetary system and each planetary system has an earth where there is life. Human beings live on these earths. Bound by the varying cycles of Time, some are more evolved than others. The more advanced humans are in contact with each other. They do travel to other earths. We are evolving and are yet to establish any contact outside. But people from other earths visit this planet often to study if we are ready for their contact. Mere advancement in science and technology is not enough, we have to evolve spiritually to understand and accept the higher laws and the higher order. They are aware of all our limitations and also

struggles. And once we come out of this phase of Pralaya, they will take the initiative to contact."

"The millions and millions of earths in the galaxies fall into fourteen categories known as Lokas or planes, based on the Spiritual condition of people there. From purely Spiritual to the totally non-spiritual conditions, the Lokas or groups of millions of earths are graded with the varying mixture of both. Our earth belongs to a category known as Bhoo Loka where conditions for both the Spiritual and the non-spiritual life exist equally."

"Above the Material Cosmos, there are four Divine planes - the plane of Creative forces where Mind is created, the plane of destructive forces and a plane in between these two, having the forces that combine the above two forces in a balanced proportion and sustain life-forms. Three Divine Personalities govern these forces. We know them as Brahma, Ishwara and Vishnu. Above these three planes, there is the plane of Female energies, the Shakti, governed by Devi and beyond this lies the plane of pure Consciousness or the formless Spirit known to us as Parabrahman, Allah or the Holy Father; God. All this Creation is an extension of God - First Devi Loka and then Shiva Loka, Vishnu Loka and Brahma Loka. From Brahma Loka, the whole Material Cosmos is extended like a telescope."

"We are from the plane of pure Consciousness. We were there, long long ago, as souls; like particles of Light, enjoying the highest state of Bliss in that timeless zone of God. Then, once, God said: "I have created Lokas, galaxies, stars and earths. I have created hills, trees, clouds and varieties of life forms. I have created human beings. If you want to experience the diversity of Life, you may visit the earths." Many of us chose to descend. Then God chose seven leaders to guide us to the earths and also back to Him. God gave

special powers and instructions to them and also explained the laws governing life on the earths. He also cautioned us not to indulge in excessive experiences. The seven leaders are known as the Sapta Rishis. They are the Hierarchy."

"We are actually space travellers; aliens on this earth who came here nearly two billion years ago. On the way, we had to pass through different atmospheres and so we acquired suitable space suits known as sheaths or koshas. First the Intellect, then the Mind and finally the Body. We entered into the body at the first stage of its development, the foetus. The Intellect and the Mind had the faculties of thinking and feeling that helped us in living and experiencing Life here. After birth when human beings grew old, became frail and died, the Sapta Rishis chose not to take birth again and remained in their Astral bodies. But we wanted to experience more and took birth again. And again. And again."

"We were warned against excessive experiences. The mind through which we experienced everything had a limitation. It could receive only an optimum quantity of experience, beyond which it rejected. The extra experiences that were rejected remained as deposits on the mind, forming a coat which began thickening, life after life. We had faculties of extraordinary perception which we lost after the coat of rejected experiences became thick. We could see and communicate with the Sapta Rishis in their Astral bodies in the beginning. But after five lifetimes, we lost this faculty. We lost contact with them. The Sapta Rishis were guiding us and were reminding us about our returning back to our Source, God. With the loss of contact, they continued to communicate through those in the human bodies who kept their mind clean without experiencing in excess. As time passed, they engaged these voluntary agents or channels permanently.

Now they have 1,44,000 channels spread all over the world. When these Light channels leave their bodies another batch of 1,44,000 channels, who will have taken birth, will take over the work."

"The Sapta Rishis had to find a way of clearing the coats of the rejected experiences. They sat in Tapas and found the way. It was Meditation! So, Meditation is not a recent discovery. It was discovered two billion years ago. The Sapta Rishis went on experimenting and improving the techniques millions of times, as this earth went through different cycles of time. They began teaching through their channels. Many souls cleaned their minds and went back. But again many came here for the first time and remained here. So, the work of the Sapta Rishis did not cease. Apart from the two batches of the channels that number 1,44,000 each, the Sapta Rishis trained many others as Rishis."

"A Rishi is a person with enormous capacities to gather and hold Knowledge and Powers in the form of Light. A Rishi is a person who can also radiate the Light of Knowledge and Power. He is a Radiant being. The 1,44,000 channels are not ordinary people. They are also Rishis. They always live like ordinary people and do not attract publicity because their work gets disturbed. The work has grown from merely channelling information to very complex processes of guiding and helping humanity in their own administration, scientific and technological progress, Spiritual evolution etc. Many times, they have to go to other earths in other galaxies to learn new things, bring new knowledge and gather new energies. They will have more work in the Astral plane. All this work is monitored and supervised by a special Rishi whose capacities are beyond our imagination. All the 1,44,000 channels will report to this Rishi in the Himalayas at midnight, going there

astrally. They take instructions from him, attend to the work, again report back to him around sunrise and then return back to their bodies."

I could not resist the temptation and interrupted Amara to ask: "Are you a channel?" Amara did not reply. He just smiled. I remember Amara describing himself a worker of the Rishis many times but I realise now that he was not only a channel, a worker, a Rishi but much more. I do not find words to describe him. Once I remarked to him - "You must be a very special person!" He replied - "Everyone is special here. Otherwise we cannot work with the Sapta Rishis."

Humility - Amara was the personification.

I have met a number of religious and Spiritual leaders, sanyasis, gurus and others but none like Amara. I remember, once a very popular swamiji wanted to meet Amara. Amara went to him. The swamiji asked many questions about Meditations and the Rishis. Amara explained. The swamiji could not accept the truth that a person wearing a modern dress and who is not a swamiji knew more! He laughed at the existence of Rishis and teased Amara, asking repeatedly, "If I lock you inside this room, will you be able to come out astrally and materialise outside?" Amara replied calmly: "Yes, I can. Please lock me in." The swamiji did not do it. He stopped teasing him. He must have somehow realised that he was facing an extraordinary man. I wonder what would have happened to his years of beliefs and prejudices if he had witnessed Amara materialising outside his room!

Amara continued:

"Some day or the other, we have to go back. We have to realize that we are not these bodies, that we are just visitors here and we

have to go back to our Home. But first, we have to liberate ourselves from ignorance, attachments and lower pleasures. It is not easy. That is why we meditate. In advanced stages of higher Meditations, we realise and experience our Divine essence and when we come back to the physical awareness, we realise the alienation. When the body collapses, when we will have cleansed our system of all impurities or residues of all experiences here and when we do not wish to return back to this plane, the Rishis take us back, in space, to our home; to God."

We sat for a long time after he ended his brief, as if to allow the Truth to integrate gradually into our world of perception. It was too big and new. I wanted more time, to assimilate. I did not speak even a word as I came away from his physical presence.

The world outside looked so different when I stepped out of his house. It always looked different after meeting Amara.

THREE

In the course of life, many questions penetrate the sphere of our awareness with their persistent stares, demanding answers to satiate their hunger. We usually ignore them, being always engaged in the daily life. Only some people focus their attention on them. And only a few find the answers to them. I believe that we can find answers to all the questions, gradually, if not immediately; over life-times, if not in this! A question must have an answer!

I had many questions and found answers to most of them with Amara, during his life-time. I got the answers to others from him even after his death. Even now, sometimes, questions do arise and I struggle in the search for answers. But, I realise that this process must go on. That is how we add meanings to life and foot-notes to chapters.

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Nothing comes on a platter. A year of Sadhana made me realise this very clearly. I was not proud of my Meditations but I was also not unhappy. I also realised that having a clear goal in the search saves a lot of time.

Right from my younger days, I was searching for something that I could not define; could not even comprehend vaguely. I read, painted and watched life flowing, unaffectedly. I keenly read about the struggles of the Spiritual Masters in the hope of a light. There were also temptations for the, now romanticised, Spiritual escapades into the distant Himalayas and caves. But I had my

binding responsibilities; I could not just run away.

When I met Amara, I was not solely in search of the Absolute; I also had problems - of money, of family. I was in search of a magical wand that would quickly vaporize all my problems so that I could continue my aimless search in books and films, weaving dreams in the long hours of tedious journeys in city buses and loneliness.

When my problems reached the peak, one day I told Amara:

"I can't suffer any more; I will commit suicide."

Amara was not shocked; he knew all. In a voice without any trace of emotion, he explained:

"You cannot escape from your Karmas. Face life. This body is a vehicle gifted by God. Don't destroy it."

Amara did not give me a magic formula or a Mantra. But he must have passed on strong Spiritual energies. I returned home strong and sensible. The problems diminished slowly. One day, when we went for a walk, I asked him:

"Did you help me in any way?"

He replied after a few silent steps:

"We always help when a person genuinely wants to grow spiritually. But we do not speak about it. If we do, people will come with all their problems only for the help and not for their Spiritual awakening!"

"But if you solve our problems, it will be easy to take up Sadhana."

"No, we have tried that. People came again with more problems! There was no end. That is why we do not interfere with Karmas and the learning process. The problems come to teach us lessons."

"Then what is the use of Meditations?"

"We don't meditate only to solve our problems. Meditations take us to the Highest Truth. On the way to the Truth, all problems vanish. Meditations burn out all our Karmas. Stick to Meditations whatever may come. You will attain your goal - the ultimate freedom; Mukti."

"Is that my goal!"

"It is everyone's goal. Many are not aware of it. After a long search and struggle, we realise it. We have bound ourselves to things, people and even ideas. We have to free ourselves; have to detach and gain freedom to go out of this plane first, then roam in other planes and finally go back to our Source - God. That is the final part - the Mukti."

"By going back, are we not surrendering our freedom there?"

"No, we are free to come down again!"

"Do souls come down again?"

"Yes, some do."

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Once, an elderly man came to Amara seeking guidance. He had chanted a Mantra thousands of times and wanted to reach the one lakh target. One night, he had a horrifying experience. During sleep, suddenly, he was in a thick engulfing darkness that choked him like death. He woke up with a violent jerk and was utterly confused. He wanted to know the reason.

Amara closed his eyes for a moment, perhaps, probing some unseen depths and then explained:

"The Mantra that you are repeating is used in the preparation for Astral Travel. It helps the separation of the Astral body from the

physical. You chanted it thousands of times. The force built up by this, forcibly separated your Astral body and ejected it out into the space. Fortunately, somehow, you could enter back into your body. Otherwise, you would have remained outside the body permanently."

"But it is a great Mantra!"

"It is! But its purpose is not known to many. We cannot play with Mantras. We have to receive them from Masters who know about their powers. And Astral travel is to be made under proper guidance. Here, the Rishis guide and monitor. They help us to separate from the physical body and also to enter back."

The elderly man was fascinated. He took up Meditations, the basic Sadhana and later on, lessons in Astral travel. One day, after weeks, he came to Amara excitedly and narrated his first successful Astral travel.

"I wanted to go to my village near Salem. I followed your instructions and went to sleep. Then suddenly I saw the house of my relatives in the village. I went into the house through the wall. It was midnight. My relatives were sitting in the hall discussing a marriage. I must have been there for about ten minutes. Then, somehow I was pulled back to my body. In the morning, I remembered every word of their discussion. I wanted to check up. So I wrote to them enquiring about the incident. My cousin wrote back confirming every detail and asked me how I knew those things!"

The elderly man was thrilled about his experience. Amara smiled and explained more about Astral travel.

On another occasion, a Meditator told my Guru that his friend had committed suicide. Amara felt sorry. He asked the Meditator to meet him the next day. Then he explained:

"Yesterday I went to the place where your friend had committed suicide. He was there. It was pathetic to see him trying to speak to his people and wondering why they were not responding. He did not know that he was dead! I explained to him. He realised it slowly. When he realised it, he began crying. He wanted to live! I felt sorry for him. I consoled him and later on took him to our Rishis in the Himalayas. From there, they will guide him to his future."

The Meditator asked Amara:

"After committing suicide, how is it he did not know that he was dead?"

"It is difficult to imagine the state of the mind immediately after death. I have seen this in many people that I have met like this. First, it takes time to realise the irreversibility of death. Then, it takes time to accept with death, all the relations with people, properties and places are severed. Then, they move away from the place, though reluctantly. In cases of natural death, a guide from the higher planes comes along with the death rays. He will stay with the dead person for some days after the death, to educate him. Then, he will take him to a particular Loka where the dead person rests sufficiently. After the rest, the dead person will undergo a check-up when his Karmas are measured. Then, people in charge of these operations will decide about his next birth. The earth, not necessarily this, where he will take birth, the place, the family, the life-time etc., will also be decided there. Again, a guide escorts the person to the place of his next birth, right upto the womb."

"What happens in cases of suicide?"

"In suicides and accidents, the guides do not come. The dead remain there for a long time and slowly realise about their death.

They will remain on this earth till their life-time ends when the guides come. They may remain in the same place or roam as they like."

"Are they the ghosts?"

"Yes."

"Can they harm?"

"They can. But not all do harm. They continue to be the same as in their life. If a person was a menace here, he continues to be a menace there also! I have met ghosts staying in temples and meditating in caves!.....You see, we do not know many things!"

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Meeting Amara was like entering into a University. He never held classes but every hour spent with him enriched us with such rare knowledge that books of this world did not contain. Once I asked him:

"Should this knowledge not reach others?"

He replied immediately as if he had addressed this point thoroughly many times earlier:

"It will reach. Gradually. This earth is now passing through a shift in Consciousness. Rishis are bringing down new energies that open up new brain cells. Men will be able to grasp new and higher knowledge gradually. Now, those who are ready will somehow get the knowledge of the New Age. Remember, there are many channels and centres of Rishis all over the world."

"Please tell me more about the New Age."

"Old scriptures and mystics speak of this. We know about Yugas - Satya, Treta, Dwapara and Kali Yugas. This is a cycle that repeats. This earth has gone through 28 cycles so far. The 28th ended in

1974. From 14th March 1974, the 29th cycle has begun. We are in Satya Yuga! Satya Yuga is called the Golden Age when men will live like gods, reaching the highest Spiritual condition of purity and perfection."

"But life around us now is most corrupt!"

"That is true. You have to understand that no change is sudden. Look at the sun-rise. First there is the dawn and then the sun-rise. There is always a transitory period. Here, the transitory period from Kali Yuga to Satya Yuga is 432 years from 1974. We are just at the beginning. But, even now, we can observe the changes at a subtler level. There is a new awareness; an awakening of consciousness. People are turning inwards; turning to Yoga, particularly Meditations. By the turn of the century, there will be major changes."

"Will there be a war?"

"Yes! But one cannot definitely predict it. This is the war of Armageddon; war between the forces of Light and darkness. It will take place at the Astral level. Then, I think, it will take place at the physical level also."

"Why don't the Rishis prevent the war?"

"They are trying. But they cannot violate the Divine laws. If people, most of them at least, choose the way of the Light, positivise their life and give up the ways of Kali Yuga, the war can be prevented. But there are no signs....So, the Rishis may have to allow it."

"Do such things also come under the Rishis' work?"

Amara smiled, intently looking at me, as if I were a small child.

"Yes. Everything!"

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A friend introduced a swami, one day, to a group of us, saying he had a lot of powers. We witnessed the swami performing miracles. He materialised Vibhuti and small objects like silver idols, fruits and helped people in their material problems. Soon there was a small crowd around him singing Bhajans, praising his powers and narrating the miracles.

Again, curiosity took me closer to him; I wanted to know how he materialised objects! The swami explained. But somehow I knew he was not revealing the truth. I asked Amara. He explained:

"It is not materialisation. It is transportation. He will gather the objects first and store them at his place. He has an Astral being, a spirit perhaps, to help. Whenever he wants to demonstrate the materialisation, he mentally requests the Astral entity to fetch the object. The entity can bring it within seconds from any distance. The object in the closed Astral hand cannot be seen. Then the swami catches it and produces it, as if from nowhere!"

"Is actual materialisation possible?"

"Yes. It is possible."

"Does Sai Baba materialise objects or....?"

Amara remained silent for a while and then spoke:

"I don't know. It is not easy to understand Masters like him. Each has his own style. We have to look beyond the miracles to know him; understand his work as a complementary part of the whole Divine project."

I explained about my association with Sai Baba earlier. Amara remarked:

"His work is mainly to attract people to the Spiritual path. For higher Sadhana through Meditations, people will have to join

Meditation groups. Sai Baba guides them to such groups."

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Amara made me meditate on Chakras. He explained everything about them. He taught me how to activate them and bring out the special faculties dormant in each Chakra. He also taught me how to operate the special powers in them, warning me never to use them without the clear approval of the Rishis. He also taught me how to contact the Rishis. So much of knowledge and so many techniques! I wondered if I deserved all this!

"Yes, you deserve these."

Amara explained during the sacred hour with him on a Friday.

"All of you deserve these. You do not know about yourselves. Let me tell you briefly. Those of you who have come to me during the period 1974 and 1979 belong to a special group. Five thousand years ago, you were young students in the Ashrama of Kripacharya. Acharyas Kripa and Drona were your teachers. At that time, they were conducting experiments in activating a special Chakra called Nirantari which is in between the Agna and Sahasrara. This is a very special Chakra which remains unknown even now. When activated, this Chakra will work as a biological clock. We can turn it to advance our age, go back to our younger days or remain at our present age for ages. Then, suddenly, they had to stop these experiments."

"Duryodhana was born. With their special faculties they could foresee the Mahabharata war. The Sapta Rishis instructed them to stop the experiments and prepare the students for the war. Then, you were taught warfare. You fought in the war and died. Then, you were entitled to rest in a special earth for 5000 years. Vishwamitra Maharshi called for volunteers to work during the

Transitory period from Kali Yuga to Satya Yuga. You volunteered. He took you to a special earth and trained you for 5000 years. That is why all these practices are bringing very fast results in you. This is only like a revision."

It was unbelievable! If it had not come from Amara, I would have laughed and joked. But I was thrilled beyond words. Before the impact of this revelation could sink in, the waves of reason and disbelief began assaulting the shores of faith. I had to allow the process and the conflict, although for a brief moment, to go on. Then faith took over. More than anything, I knew my Guru as person of great integrity; he was a great Rishi.

Amara could read me. He knew what was going on within me. He smiled and went on speaking:

"I know how you must be feeling about this revelation. But do not allow this to bloat your ego. There are many in this world now with a greater past. You happen to know your past by chance. You can re-arrange your life without affecting others. Now, let me add one more thrill. We all know, Kripacharya is a Chiranjeevi, who lives forever. I have met him physically!"

After the initial thrills, we all got used to the most extraordinary revelations. As I mentioned earlier, I cannot print all. I am bound by the instructions from my Guru and by the Divine Laws. Now I realise how much of activity in the Astral and even in this plane remains unknown to us forever and how humanity is helped by Light Beings from the higher planes!

Amara narrated:

"I was studying in High School. One day, the Rishis asked me to take leave from the school for two weeks, go to the Cubbon park and wait at a particular spot. I waited. Within minutes, an

Englishman came in a car and asked my name. I told him. He took me to the Airport. He had a special plane waiting there. From there he took me to Calcutta and from Calcutta to Hongkong. In Hongkong, he took me to a chinese and told me: "This person will take you further and bring you back. I will again pick you up from here." He told me when exactly he will come to pick me up."

"After food and rest, the chinese took me to the port and from there we travelled in a boat for about three hours. He left me on a shore saying, "From here another person will escort you and will bring you back here. I will pick you up from here." He told me the day and time. I joined the person waiting on the shore and walked along with him, as if, in a dream! We walked for nearly two days and came to a valley full of vegetation with trees and shrubs. There were also beautiful birds. We walked for sometime and came to a huge cave. We entered the cave which had an opening on the other side. When we came out, I could not believe my eyes! There were huge buildings and people! A young man met us at the entrance and welcomed us with a smile. He also knew we were coming!"

"We were taken into a building where we had a bath, food and rest for the night. I was taken to a hall in the morning where a majestic person in his forties was seated. He smiled at me and gestured me to be seated. He spoke in Sanskrit which I could not understand. So we spoke telepathically. He was the great Kripacharya!"

"He explained to me the necessity of my meeting him physically and gave me detailed instructions about a future project that I had to take up near Bangalore and several other works involving him. After that, he took me to an area where many youngsters were studying in the typical Gurukula way. Finally he bade me farewell."

"I, along with my escort, started on our journey back from there, the next morning. He brought me to the shore, retracing our journey on foot. The boat and the chinese were waiting for me. Again, the Englishman was waiting for me in Hongkong. I was back in the same spot in Cubbon park exactly in two weeks!"

After the narration and after the sudden silence that followed, I asked Amara:

"How old is Kripacharya?"

Amara replied:

"Thousands of years."

FOUR

I entered the third year of Sadhana; it was 1979.

My Sadhana continued with the Meditations on Chakras during this year. There were ups and downs. Amara explained them as natural; like day and night. Perseverance was the key. I did not have many experiences with Meditations like others. Some experiences that I had were good. Amara explained some and smiled at others. He used to tell everyone:

"Experiences do not measure your Sadhana. If you do not have experiences, do not worry. Remember, sometimes the mind itself will project experiences! Never go after experiences. Then, you will be deviating from Sadhana."

"What exactly should we go after, in Sadhana?"

"In Meditations - Silence. During Silence, Spiritual processes occur by themselves at different levels. While not meditating, you have to make efforts to transform yourselves by cultivating all good qualities and bringing out the Divine Love from the deepest level of your existence."

"Why do you give so much importance to Meditation?"

"Because that is the ultimate step in Sadhana which enables us to directly experience and realise God. Do not ask how this helps in our daily life. Meditations take us nearer God. Our experiencing Him brings wisdom and enormous inner strength. We will never be the same after that. Then, we will take proper decisions in life

and choose the right things. These help us attend to any problem and face any situation without losing our peace within. We will be happy and peaceful. What more do we require?"

"Is Meditation different from Tapas?"

"Yes. We meditate for our benefit. Rishis perform Tapas for everyone's benefit."

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As more aspirants joined, Amara could not meet us individually. He began meeting us in small groups which had its own advantages. Different people would ask different questions. The opportunities to know more increased. In the beginning, I thought that our interaction with Amara, at the personal level, would be impaired. But it did not happen. I could meet him individually on any day. Amara also began visiting different houses in different areas every week, where Meditators in that area gathered on a particular day.

We used to gather and sing one or two Bhajans and wait for Amara. He would come exactly at the fixed time. He would first narrate one of his works with the Rishis and then answer our questions. After that, we would all meditate together. During one such Meditation, I heard someone calling me. Again, it was not a physical voice but a telepathic one! Someone was asking me - "I want you to do some work. I will give you all my powers. Will you do it?" I was perturbed. I did not know what to reply. I told Amara. He asked me not to respond, saying such calls would come often.

On Sundays, Amara would meet Meditators in the mornings to check up their progress in Meditations, to correct their mistakes and initiate them into the next Chakra, periodically. More people began coming to take up Meditations although there was no

publicity. Almost all of them were educated and young. I estimated more than 2000 students coming to him, after me. I remember Amara remarked once: "Before 1974 about 5000 people were guided to Mukti. They will not come back to this earth again. Those who have come afterwards are required for work here. We will meet again in the next birth. This work will go on for nearly 400 years more."

Someone asked: "What about our Mukti?"

Amara looked at him amusedly, replying,

"Consider, it is in your pocket! The Rishis will help. You can attain that stage in this life itself. But we will not go back. We stay back to do God's work. But there is no compulsion. You are all free to choose."

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Once during a gathering in the evening, Amara spoke about Shambala.

"The four Yuga cycle, which is roughly 51,000 years, is called a Mahayuga. Seventy one Mahayugas make one Manvantara. At the end of every Manvantara, there will be a total Pralaya. All life on earth will be destroyed. After millions of years, life again evolves from Amoeba. This is happening from nearly two billion years, since the formation of this earth. So far, six Manvantaras have passed by. That means, six times life here got totally extinguished and began again."

"At the end of the last Manvantara, the whole earth was covered with water and only one person survived the Pralaya! It was Markandeya Maharshi, blessed with eternal life by a boon from Lord Shiva. He stayed on the top of a mountain, in a cave and sat in Tapas. For more than ten thousand years, he did Tapas and

then woke up to see if life had begun. Then, he had a vision of a blue baby floating on water. He realised, it was Mahavishnu and prayed. He was told that at the place where he saw the vision, land would surface shortly and life would begin. When the island came up, the Rishi called it Shyama-Bala, meaning blue baby. He decided to preserve this island as a sacred place. Then life began, time rolled on, continents rose and civilisations grew. The Rishi gathered only the pure and the enlightened here. Rishis took birth here. As time passed, the word Shyama-Bala became Shambala."

"We are in the seventh Manvantara now and twenty-eight Mahayugas have passed by. That means, Shambala is twenty-eight Mahayugas old! The Rishis have kept this place untouched by the influence of time; untouched by the influence of Yugas of diluted or no values like the Kali Yuga. Over this long unbroken period of time, a civilisation of the highest order has flourished here. Science of the highest order has evolved. Men living here have been using spaceships from thousands of years! Men live for eternity. They do not age or die here. We cannot even imagine the advancement of life here."

"Shambala is somewhere in the Gobi desert. Many people are aware of its existence but are unable to reach it because the Rishis have sealed this off from the outside world. But a person in the highest Spiritual condition can reach Shambala with the permission of the Rishis. The Rishis guide him to reach Shambala. It will be a one way journey; into Shambala. Many have gone there. I know some of the contemporary Masters. I do not mention the names because it may create an unnecessary controversy or confusion."

"Shambala is ruled by a king called Maitreya. This is not the Maitreya that some people say is coming to earth as the Saviour.

He is not Buddha. He is a special soul from Soorya Loka. People here are busy with different occupations chosen by them. Further research in all branches of science, including the Spiritual science, goes on here incessantly. A huge golden lotus is mounted on a palatial building. There is a huge ruby in it. A very great power is placed here. The vibrations from this fill up the entire Shambala keeping it Divine. People from outside also can draw energies from this by chanting the Mantra "Om Mani Padme Hum". This Mantra is known to many in Tibet."

"The knowledge gathered in Shambala is meant for all. Shambalites do not intend keeping all their accomplishments only to themselves. But they cannot also pass on the knowledge to the outside world because of our degenerated Spiritual condition. We are not fit enough to receive the higher knowledge. And the people in Shambala are waiting for us to awaken and grow."

"I have astrally visited Shambala many times. I have met the people there. I have more information on Shambala. But I think this is enough, for now. I have not spoken about Shambala without any purpose. Now that we are entering into Satya Yuga, the time for Shambala to open up for us has come. As we advance into Satya Yuga, not only Shambala opens up but conditions outside Shambala will also become like that of Shambala gradually. Shambala spreads out and, maybe, after four hundred years, the whole earth will be like Shambala. We, being under the Sapta Rishis, have to work for it. First, we have to spiritually grow enough to receive Shambala individually and then spread it."

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Once, a Meditator who had visited Sant Gnaneshwar's Samadhi in Maharashtra, was speaking to me about it. Amara called both of us into the pooja room. He asked the Meditator:

"There is a painting of Eknath there. Did you see?"

The Meditator said: "Yes."

"Did you find anything unusual there?"

The Meditator struggled to recollect and was wondering when Amara spoke with an unusual glint in his eyes.

"Next time when you go there, observe. His face is like mine; I was Eknath!"

This sudden revelation stunned us. After the initial numbness, I was wondering why did he speak it out; speak out to us! It was unlike him. He always spoke about the Rishis but never about himself much.

"I do not know why I am telling you all this. Perhaps, you are ordained to know. But do not spread this to others now."

Then he paused, as if recapturing something from the distant past.

"Sant Gnaneshwar was a great Spiritual Master. He was very young when he entered the Jiva-Samadhi. As he sat in Meditation and entered into the state of Samadhi, a room-like structure was built around him and all the openings were sealed off. This was more than six hundred years ago. If you read the life of Eknath, you will come across an incident where Eknath enters Gnaneshwar's Samadhi and removes the root of a tree that was touching Gnaneshwar's head. Well, I had to repeat that in 1966!"

"One day, Markandeya Maharshi instructed me to remove a root that had grown too long and was almost touching the head of Gnaneshwar. Following his instructions, I entered the Samadhi and cut off the disturbing root. What amazes me, even now, is the sight of the great Master who looked as young as when he sat down

there, more than six hundred years ago! He looked so fresh, as if he had taken a bath and sat for Tapas just then! The whole place inside was very clean. Some Astral beings must have been visiting daily and keeping it clean, because I saw a burning lamp and Rangoli freshly drawn!"

"How can a person sit so long like that and also look so young?", I asked Amara.

"There are so many things that we are not aware of. The physical science grew wonderfully well with all its new branches. We ignored the Spiritual science. This science also has grown and is growing. Look at the accomplishments of Aurobindo and Yogananda! When we practise certain techniques and sit for Tapas, our bodies will remain as they are, for any number of years. And people can sit like this in Tapas for thousands of years. I have come across many such Tapasvis."

"When Kali Yuga begins, some Rishis living in their physical bodies will skip this by doing Tapas for more than five thousand years, which is the approximate duration of Kali Yuga. Before sitting for Tapas, they intimate our Rishis in the Himalayas about how long they would perform Tapas and request the Rishis to wake them up afterwards. It is like an alarm arrangement! During this period they are protected against any disturbance and after the period, they will be woken up promptly. I was involved in waking up several Rishis. I will briefly tell you about one."

Amara continued and we remained the most attentive listeners.

"It was a temple in North Karnataka. I cannot give you the specific details. They are not important. I was instructed to awaken a Rishi who was in Tapas there for about five thousand years. I

travelled there physically. The temple was on a hillock and there were not many worshippers. The few there were from the nearest village which was several kilometres away."

"By the evening, all the worshippers had left the place and the poojari was about to lock the temple. He was also from that village. I requested him to permit me to stay in the temple for the night. First, he denied. Then he asked many questions. It was not easy to convince him that I liked the temple and wanted to meditate there in the night. Then, reluctantly, he agreed."

"Although the temple was small, there was a huge pond inside the compound. A Rishi was with me astrally all the time. We took the permission of the goddess there, after invoking her and explaining our mission. She blessed us. We waited till midnight approached. I did not know how to proceed or what exactly I had to do. I was depending on the Rishi who was explaining many details about that place - how a king had a dream wherein he was asked to build a temple there and all his wishes were accomplished after building the temple. He took up Sanyas later on."

"As midnight approached, the Rishi asked me if I knew swimming. I said "No." He felt sorry because I had to go down into the pond! I had no choice but to follow his instructions. I closed my eyes and nose and jumped into the pond. The Rishi dragged me under water across the depth and pulled me up. I could breathe and open my eyes in a few but very long minutes. We had reached a cave! The whole cave was dimly lit; the source of the light was not seen. And in a corner, a person was sitting in Tapas!"

"The Rishi gave me instructions silently; we were of course, communicating telepathically. The Rishi gave me a small bottle that he got materialised. There was some oil in the bottle. The Rishi asked me to smear the body of the person with the oil. I smeared

very carefully. He was not breathing and the body was cold. After smearing, the Rishi asked me to whisper a Mantra he gave me, in the ear of the person sitting there. I did. Then he asked me to quickly plunge into the water and when I did, he quickly brought me to the other side of the pond and I surfaced. A moment later, there was a big sound under the water as if there was an explosion and I could see the waves in the dark water. The Rishi explained to me without any excitement: "Now, he has opened his eyes!"

"I slept there till the morning. The priest opened the door from outside and was relieved to see that everything there was as it was, the previous evening. I smiled and thanked him and came out."

As I climbed down the hillock, I saw a tall person waiting. He was the Rishi who had been doing Tapas in the cave under the pond! I wondered how he had come out! He asked me mentally:

"Who is the king now?"

I explained that there were no kings now; we had Democracy. He could not understand it. I explained clearly. Then he asked me for the directions to go to Kashi. He wanted to walk. I told him he need not walk; we had transport vehicles. I gave him money. He was amused, looking at the paper-money. He did not accept the money and chose to walk. As the seven-foot-Tapasvi walked away majestically, I knew that I would not see him again. My emotions were stirred. I stared at the space from where he gradually disappeared, walking for a long time."

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It was a Tuesday, the day when we gathered in a house in our area. I went there after missing two Tuesdays. I was late. When I hurried there, I was shocked to see Amara standing alone in front of that locked house. The people in that house did not want the

gathering there. So, they had locked and gone out giving enough hints to the other visitors who had not come there that day. The house had been locked even the previous Tuesday. I felt very sorry and awkward. Amara smiled at me and explained in a very comforting voice:

"Whenever we have such gatherings, a Rishi will come and there will be many Astral visitors who would come to learn more and meditate. I am waiting here to greet them and tell them that we cannot meet here any more. I have come across all types of people. I have seen more life. It is easy to feel bitter about things like this. But we should not. This is a part of our work. You too will encounter many bitter experiences. But never lose patience. If you do, you will lose the goal."

I had never seen Amara getting upset or angry about anything. Disappointed? Yes, several times - whenever we could not rise to his expectations, perhaps, like every Master. His way of reacting to things was entirely different and sublime.

"Negating life is easy. To love it, it is not easy. We have to rise above all the dualities of this plane and look at life from a higher perspective. All this is an expression of God; both good and bad. There are lessons in both. The lesson is important not the pain. Meditations alone do not teach us everything. They open the doors. We have to study, contemplate and dream. You have to be a mystic, philosopher and a poet. Then we can look at the whole and experience God in Meditation, nature and expansion of consciousness. Aurobindo said, "All Life is Yoga." How true it is!"

Amara was not just a teacher of Meditation, a Guru. He was a Master, a field of power from which we could draw strength always. He was like a parent with whom we could confide anything and expect the most proper guidance and unconditional

help. Once, I took a friend of mine who had just then got married. He spent an hour with Amara alone and when he came out, he was beaming with satisfaction. When asked, Amara had explained to him about sex and marriage. My friend was a Muslim. He wanted to meditate. Amara had given him the appropriate instructions and even a Mantra in Urdu!

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The weekly group gatherings in different areas became very interesting and rewarding. His casual understatements about the present day life became highly educative. We never knew that we could approach life from a different perspective. His casual utterances about the future events would always come true. He never discussed politics but he knew everything. Once he remarked: "Who will believe if I say that Indira Gandhi may lose her election?" No one would. But she lost! From then on, every word he uttered was carefully noted in our minds and we came across most wonderful revelations.

In one of the weekly gatherings, Amara explained:

"Sometimes people ask me, 'What have the Astral worlds got to do with our life, now?' or 'Is Astral travel a Spiritual practice?' I do not answer them because these things cannot be explained in isolation, without some preliminary knowledge. But you can understand. Remember, this physical world is an extension of the Astral. Events occur first in the Astral world and then they physicalise. It could be elections or world wars. It could be a birth or a marriage; an accident or a promotion! If we can enter the Astral plane now and peep into the future, we can know so much! But there is nothing like a destiny that will definitely take place. Any future event can be changed by Spiritual powers. By Meditations. An accident can be averted and also a world war."

"That is why we do so much of work in the Astral plane so that the welfare work brings results in the physical plane. No one knows how much our Rishis struggled to help us to get freedom from the British! It is a very long story. After we got the Independence, Vishwamitra Maharshi wanted to give this country a gift. He went to the highest plane and brought a great power. He wanted to give this to a strong person. A leader, whose only job was to just accept it on behalf of the country and preserve it. He met many leaders of that time astrally. But no one was ready to accept it. It was very strange. Each one had his own preoccupation! He sent word through me to the heroes of Mahabharata, who were in a special earth which was like heaven, to come down and accept the power on behalf of this country. Sadly, they also were reluctant to come immediately. The Rishi was disappointed. Then he hurled the power into the sky which exploded like a million bombs. I was near the explosion and my Astral body was affected by it. After I came back to the physical body, I felt a burning sensation all over. The doctors could not help. Then Vishwamitra Maharshi came and healed me. After that, he went away from this galaxy, perhaps, to perform Tapas in a far away galaxy. It was 1948. And now, he has returned!"

That was sensational! We asked many questions. Amara answered everyone. We were all thrilled when Amara explained:

"Vishwamitra Maharshi wants to form a special group of Meditators. He is going to give special techniques and instructions and before that he will initiate all those who join this group with a special Mantra. For nearly seventeen years, we have been energising a Mantra to be used for this purpose. Those of you who wish to join, get initiated. The initiations will be conducted by the Rishi himself. It will go on for a week from tomorrow."

Nearly seven hundred Meditators got initiated into this special group. I was there on the first day itself. I joined the queue and moved on. Amara was seated in a corner. He was instructing everyone:

"Go one by one into the Pooja room. The Rishi is sitting there. You may see him or may not. He is in his Astral body. Sit before the idol of Krishna there and repeat this Mantra once. Only once. Then get up and come out. These few seconds are enough. He will inject the special energy into your system which will be with you for several life-times."

We were all naturally excited. When I entered the room, I tried hard to see the Rishi. I could not. But, yes, I could feel his presence. Even if Amara had not spoken about his presence, I would have felt it. It was such a strong and awesome presence that anyone would have felt it. I repeated the Mantra once. Then, I could feel the energy entering me like a flash. Amara was right, a few seconds were enough. I came out. If I had remained in the room for a few seconds more, I would have lost the consciousness of this world.

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We began visiting Amara often. He began narrating the activities of the great Vishwamitra Maharshi. Vishwamitra Maharshi was not one of the Sapta Rishis now. The Sapta Rishis change with every new Manvantara. Even then, the Sapta Rishis always seek and follow his guidance in major works, and request him to help in some very special work. One special work at that time was the tuning up of a gadget in the Himalayas.

Amara explained:

"This gadget is huge like a mountain. It is a physical object and can only be operated by special Spiritual energies. And

Vishwamitra Maharshi is the only one who can do it. This gadget will be sending out vibrations that will create conditions in the minds of all people for the Spiritual life suitable to that particular Age or Yuga. So far, it is set to Kali Yuga and now it has to be tuned up to Satya Yuga."

One of the Meditators asked:

"If these vibrations affect our minds and thinking then where is freedom of our choice?"

"Yes, to some extent these vibrations influence us. But only to some extent. We can always overpower them. You see, in Kali Yuga the vibrations may push us towards Adharma. It will be difficult to follow the righteous path. It will be difficult even to meditate. That is why the Rishis had prescribed simple ways like just repeating the name of God. But we can always resist the influence and make our choice."

Tuning up of that Spiritual gadget was not an easy task. There were several trials and each time the vibrations had to be absorbed by the Rishis' workers first. Many workers died during the trials. Amara had a heart attack.

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It was 1980.

Amara recovered from the heart attack gradually. But his movements were restrained. He could not attend the weekly gatherings at different areas as earlier, in the city. He trained some of us who volunteered and instructed us to visit the centres to conduct a kind of satsang on his behalf. It was a golden opportunity for us to learn from him systematically and to convey his messages and instructions to others. The respect shown to us in these meetings by the gathered Meditators was very discomfoting. When we mentioned this to Amara, he said:

"Pass it on to the Rishis. Never forget even for a moment that you are just tools and they are the Masters."

He also instructed us how to link up to the Rishis during these hours. The Rishis would answer questions and channel knowledge through us. This was a great experience for everyone of us. We answered questions for which we had no prior knowledge. We explained things that we had not understood. We reported everything to Amara every time like small children with excitement and joy. Amara was happy. He told us:

"I want everyone of you to shine like the Rishis, independently, some day. But I am afraid that your egos may keep you down; be careful!"

Now looking back, I realise how true were his words as

portents. Our enemies are our own egos that pull us down from any height and also bring down our mansions along with us.

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Once, Amara narrated a strange incident:

"I had a visitor in the last week. He was very tall and handsome. He was a foreigner. He wanted to start a Gurukula near Bangalore. I have some land twenty kilometres away from here. Somehow, he knew the details. He wanted huge structures to be built up there. Of course he would finance. His project was very fascinating. He wanted twelve structures to be built, each accommodating fifty to sixty students and each with a huge open space. Young boys at the age of twelve would be taken into the Gurukula. They would spend one year in each structure, studying both the Spiritual and the modern sciences, arts, philosophy, Meditation and martial arts! Each structure would be headed by a Master who would be assisted by their juniors. A young boy who enters this Gurukula would emerge as a young man, well versed in different branches of knowledge and would fit in anywhere in society and would be an ideal citizen."

"Listening to him was a beautiful experience. He wanted our help also. He told me that he would meet me later on and went out. For a moment, I stayed in my room, strangely, a bit dazed. Then I rushed out to see him off. But I did not find him! It was very strange. Then, I realised that the door had remained closed when he came in and also when he went out! He must have come astrally and then materialised here. I wondered who it was but could not make out. I decided to report this to Markandeya Maharshi in the night and ask about him. But when I went to the Himalayas in the night, I saw the person seated near the Rishi, discussing something! He smiled at me. Then Markandeya Maharshi introduced him to me. I

cannot tell you who he was. But I want all of you to prepare yourself to work for this wonderful project. When you are ready, he will come."

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My Sadhana moved on from meditating on Chakras to the initial stages of Samadhi. Experiencing Samadhi would require life-times of Sadhana. But here we were, on its threshold! It was unbelievable. My book knowledge ceased to throw light any more. Amara explained:

"It is total silence from now on; total surrender. Then only, you can expand in Consciousness. You can expand to any limits. It depends on you. From now on, the real Sadhana begins."

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My life was not smooth. I blundered and with all my noble intentions and uncompromising ideals, I covered myself with confusion. I was over-confident that somehow people around me would recognise my innate goodness. But somehow, I lost people and their sympathy. I had difficulties on the financial front which would unnerve anyone and affect the confidence. Only Meditations kept me alive and hopeful.

Once, a Rishi met me astrally and explained about why I had to go through these very trying situations. He also warned me that my problems would increase. He explained to me that because I had chosen this difficult path of Sadhana and a destiny that would alienate all relations eventually, to take up an unusual work, I had to go through this track of Karmas of penury and ignominy. This, no doubt, eased my conscience and boosted my courage. But unwittingly, I committed more mistakes and regretted silently, which did not help.

Amara knew all these. He never discussed my problems, did not advise me about anything and did not judge me like others. He just watched and waited.

I increased my Meditations.

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Once an American lady visited Amara. She had unusual psychic powers. She could see into the past and the future of anyone when she focussed her psychic attention. When she exhibited her gifts, people were thrilled. Finally, before leaving, she focussed her attention on Amara. We were all very curious about what she would reveal. After a long moment, she opened her eyes and said:

"It is unusual! I cannot probe into you! I had only two visions. In one of your past lives, you did not have your hands. They were chopped off. And in another life, you were a king in another country!"

Amara smiled at her observations and remained silent. After she left, we pestered him to explain these two visions. He was reluctant. He said:

"These may give thrills but they do not help. What we are now is important."

But we persisted. He could not resist our affectionate pressure. He explained, of course, cautioning us not to speak about such things to others. The first vision was about Gora Kumbara and the second one was about Ramses II!

We were all thrilled and remained speechless. Each one of us was thinking, in that hushed silence, about many things that would remain unrevealed.

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Amara had fifty acres of land near the city, twenty kilometres away in the north-eastern direction. He called it Manovati, after the name of a city in Brahma Loka. This had a wonderful history.

More than sixty years ago, when Amara was in his teens, the Rishis asked him to go to a nearby hillock and perform Tapas for twenty-four days. There was a small shrine-like stone structure on the hillock. Amara stayed there. During midnight, he noticed daily, a golden ball of light slowly descending from the sky at a particular area and going back into the sky before dawn. It was a strange and beautiful spectacle. Growing curious, one night, Amara went to the place where it had landed but could not see the light. It had gone down into the earth. He marked the place and returned. After the completion of his Tapas, the Rishis told him that they had chosen the place to open their centre, later on, and were bringing down a special energy every night to spiritually prepare the place for their future work. An area around that spot, with a radius of one kilometre would be thus ready.

The Rishis instructed Amara to purchase some land there. Amara tried but could not succeed for nearly twenty-five years! But he never gave up his efforts till he could get this land. After purchasing the land twenty-five more years had elapsed. He had put up a small structure for his residence. He did not, perhaps, deliberately develop the land into a farm. It remained barren and uninhabited. His wife was running a monthly medical camp there with the help of some doctors. Some of us began helping in the medical service. Thus a love affair between us and the land began.

When I visited Manovati for the first time, I was arrested by the sea of serenity and the quiet solitude there. I wondered how great the experience would be to live there!

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On February 16, 1980, there was a total solar eclipse. Amara invited Meditators to Manovati to mass-meditate during the eclipse time. More than seven hundred people volunteered. Huge Shamianas were erected and transport from the city was arranged. Amara gave special techniques to meditate during the eclipse period. It was a long period; about four hours. We meditated and took small breaks to loosen our limbs, not used to such long sittings. During one such spell, a few people wanted to offer 'Tarpana' to their dead parents. I remember the exact words from Amara:

"Those of you who want the Kingdom of God stay here and meditate."

I and many stayed back. But some hurried out to offer 'Tarpana'. Amara told us, later on, that it was a Spiritual occasion that comes once in fifty-one thousand years and our Meditations on that day had released our parents and grandparents from all their binding Karmas! Amara also narrated to us, a great Astral work attended by the Rishis:

"The Rishis were conducting a great Yagna from a year that has ended now. They wanted to inject every soul on this earth with a special energy that would sprout Spiritual seeds in their systems; the seeds for the Kingdom of God, promised by Jesus. This would help everyone in tuning up to the New Age, Satya Yuga, gradually. They chose an earth in Soorya Loka and gathered thousands of Rishis from different earths and galaxies. Vishwamitra Maharshi went in search of a very great Rishi called Vishwadeva, who alone knew several secret procedures and found him in a very far off galaxy in the Divine plane. Vishwadeva gladly joined the Yagna."

"As the Yagna was nearing the end, help from the Divine personalities was also obtained. During the eclipse, the

Poornahuti was offered and a very great power rose from the Yagna-Kunda. It was like another sun. The Rishis covered it with darkness and brought it slowly nearer to our earth. The energy from this was very carefully released when every soul here received the energy at a deeper level. Then they took the power back and released it back to its plane. The Meditators received more energy. Do not think we alone meditated here. Many individuals and groups meditated in other parts of the world. Many knew the importance, if not all these details."

People in Madurai saw a golden light surrounded by a circle of white light in the sky after the eclipse. This was reported by the Newspapers. While returning to the city, I too saw circles of light. When we reported these to Amara and asked him if the light was the power that the Rishis had brought, he said "Yes."

A person wanted to take photographs on that day. He asked for permission. Amara gave permission but he did not want to be photographed. Overpowered by enthusiasm, the person did not heed Amara's words and took several photographs of him. But when the film was developed, the person found only blanks wherever Amara was photographed and the other photos were clear! Amara smiled! And did not say a word about it.

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I did not force any changes on myself. But I was aware of the new beginnings within. There was peace, hope and confidence.

I continued to read and did not paint, but followed the movements in art. I had carefully preserved my writings and paintings. One day, I asked Amara:

"Will everything perish in Pralaya?"

I was thinking of my writings and paintings!

"Most of the things perish."

"Will the arts and literature also perish? What about Shakespeare and Kalidasa?"

"We lose all in Time. But greater things will come again; There will be new Vedas. There will be new continents, new mountains and rivers. Man will climb new heights in glory. There will be no wars; no diseases. There will be no violence. There will be great civilisations. Greater arts and greater literature. We cannot have any idea of the New Age now. It will be entirely different. It will truly be the Kingdom of God where each man shines in his innate Divine glory."

My writings, my paintings!.....paper boats in the mighty ocean of Time!

One day, I collected all my paint tubes and brushes and gave them to a child who smeared the paints all over its world. I burnt my writings. I did not feel great about doing these. And I did not regret.

I wanted to meditate more. And grow. Like Amara.

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Amara shifted his residence. One day, I saw him sitting outside the new house looking a bit worried. I asked him about it. He explained:

"I am waiting for the gods."

I was puzzled and he could easily make it out. He explained further:

"We have shifted the idols of gods from that house. But the powers kept in them are yet to be shifted. You see, the energies sink into earth as time passes. We have to now raise them first and then

shift. It is taking time."

That explained his worry. I could not resist recounting the instances of my worrying - a deflated tyre, a delayed breakfast, a crippling drizzle, a missing button, missing a bus.....!!

That was the only occasion when I saw Amara worried like that!

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What made Amara great was not just Astral works and links. He was able to explain the truths by the knowledge that he directly gathered from its Divine source like every great Rishi. The Rishis are known for their direct perception of truths. Amara was a modern Rishi. His dress, language and life-style were modern. That was how, perhaps, he could easily relate himself to us. He could interpret the ancient truths in a scientific way and made them applicable in our daily life. The truths from our Vedas and Upanishads did not remain any more in the obscurity of highflown words, in neatly bound books adorning the libraries. They became alive as the guiding lights. We could take any doubt to him and he would clarify it in very clear and simple terms.

Once, we had an Australian visitor who was well-read and sharp in intellect. He poured questions after questions and Amara answered every one of them. The Australian was amazed. He asked Amara how he knew so much? Amara replied:

"I do not know. I establish a link with the Rishis and get the answers. They know everything. They are the Masters."

I have met many swamis and yogis. I saw most of them as feeble moons.

The religious leaders were bound by their own superstitions and conventions that the founder Masters would not have dreamt of. All that they could give us were long sermons and longer rituals. They were not equipped to guide us spiritually in this modern world of complexities and hurried pace of life. Amara was like a sun; we could see and understand the truths of life in his Light. If I had not met him, I would not have known that the dhoti was not essential to meditate; we could wear pyjamas and also meditate!

Once, recently, I had a very amusing encounter with a sanyasi. I wanted to conduct Meditation classes in a place and had obtained permission from the authorities. The sanyasi who came as a visitor to that place stayed on. He had an attractive background. He was a computer man before he took up the saffron. He knew Russian and Sanskrit. He studied our scriptures and took initiation into Sanyas from the head of a big Mutt. He wanted to meet me, to acquaint with, before the Classes. When he saw me, he must have been terribly disappointed. He nearly screamed at me asking,

"Why don't you wear a dhoti? How can you teach Meditation like this?"

I was dressed in kurta and pyjamas. I explained to him that it was difficult to ride a two-wheeler wearing a dhoti. But he did not agree. He said it was against our culture. I could not stand up to his indignation. I had to give up the idea of the Meditation classes! I wonder how he would have reacted if he had seen Amara dressed in shirt and trousers!

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There is a small structure in a very picturesque land near Nandi hills. Once, there was an Ashrama there. Some people wanted to perform a Yagna there. Amara advised them against it. But the

organisers went ahead and performed the Yagna. Amara told us that the people involved in it will have problems. When a political leader who was involved in the Yagna lost power, Amara attributed it to the ill effects of the Yagna. I was not interested in all these. When I went there, I had a very interesting experience.

There was a cave in an adjoining hill. A Rishi was said to be performing Tapas in that cave. Even the villagers there knew about this. A villager narrated to me an incident where, not long ago, a few cowherds had seen a tall bearded person emerging out of the cave. One of them threw a stone at him presuming that he was a mad man. The stone hit the person but turned into a flower and fell down. He smiled and called those boys to come near and gave them fruits that they had not seen. After sometime, he went inside.

Amara knew him! He told us that he had met him several times. He was a person from the times of Mahabharata! He was doing Tapas there for a particular purpose and he wanted to assist the Rishis in the work of Pralaya. We wanted to go to that cave and meet him, if possible. Amara spoke to him telepathically and told us that the Rishi had given permission to visit the cave and meditate there but he would not come out to meet us.

My friend asked Amara:

"If he is doing Tapas, how can you talk to him even mentally?"

Amara explained:

"I contacted him at a different level of awareness. It is possible."

"We climbed our way to the cave and found it to be a small one. We sat down in a circle and began meditating. After a few minutes, I saw the Rishi coming out and standing in the centre of the circle and looking at everyone with a smile. Looking at me, he spoke to

me in a voiceless voice:

"Do not get excited. This is not the first time we are meeting. We will meet again. I know your Guru from a long time. He is a very great Master. You are fortunate to be with him. God bless you."

Then he vanished. We meditated for sometime and after that, most of us were jumping. We had visions to share. We had seen the Rishi and he had spoken to us, simultaneously. We reported all these to Amara. As usual, he just smiled. He knew!

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One day, Amara narrated his Astral work that he had attended during that week. He was asked to go to another galaxy and invite a Rishi living on an earth there to come to the Himalayas. Amara travelled there astrally. He said every time he travelled to another galaxy, it was a wonderful experience for him - to zoom past the stars and earths and admire the shape of our galaxy from a distance.

We asked him, how he could go to a particular earth and how could he identify it. He explained that it was not difficult for him. He was fitted with several Astral gadgets that guided him. Every worker under the Rishis will have many gadgets fitted in. Amara had mastered a special technique that led him straight to the destination.

Amara went to the Rishi. At that time he was talking to a person. He saw Amara entering his hut, smiled at him and gestured him to sit down.

"On that earth, people did not have physical bodies. They lived in their Astral bodies. So there were no births and deaths as on this earth."

"Was that earth like ours?"

"Yes. But everything there was in the Astral form - the mountains, birds, etc. I have come across stranger earths. There is one earth which is self-luminous. It is lit from its own core. It was wonderful to see huge fish in the sea illumined by a light beneath the sea."

Amara conveyed to the Rishi, the message from Markandeya Maharshi in the Himalayas. The Rishi said he was busy at that time. He asked Amara to come to him the next day. Amara went there the next day and escorted the Rishi to the Himalayas. Markandeya Maharshi requested him to help in retrieving a gadget from a place in Italy. Again, Amara accompanied the Rishi to Italy. At a place where, once upon a time, were the twin cities of Sodom and Gomorroh, they went underground and the Rishi spent more than an hour searching for the gadget and found it. This Rishi was Dhanvantari and he was known to the Greeks as Escalaepeus, the god of medicine. He knew about the gadget. It was used in the blowing of Sodom and Gomorroh when the people there did not heed the words of God, warning them about their sinful ways of life.

The gadget was handed over to Markandeya Maharshi. Dhanvantari stayed on for a few days more on this earth and then returned to his earth. Markandeya Maharshi made over this gadget to Lord Kalki.

Lord Kalki! We wanted to know more about him. Amara briefed us:

"Lord Kalki was born in 1924, in Shambala. He was educated and trained in Shambala like other Avataras. Now he is living in Shambala. He remains at the age of twenty-four years because in Shambala, people do not age more for any number of years. Our Rishis are equipping him with more powers and gadgets for use,

later on, during the destructive part of Pralaya. He is the one who will judge people and punish. He is waiting for indications from the Sapta Rishis to begin his work. The Sapta Rishis are constantly monitoring the responses from humanity to the requirements of the New Age and are reporting to him. If humanity does not rise to the expectations, Lord Kalki will contact every individual on earth through the mass communication systems like the TV and Radio and will address them, not once, but several times before plunging himself into action. Then he wipes out all Adharma and the people holding on to it from the face of this earth."

"Will we be able to meet him?"

"Yes."

"When?"

"I cannot tell you. But first you have to prepare yourself to meet him."

"How?"

"By Meditations and spiritualizing your lives."

SIX

It was 1981.

My Sadhana continued. There were brief spells of total silence during the long hours of Meditation. Even in that silence, there were thoughts. I was aware of them. I was aware of everything around me. But everything seemed to be existing at another level. I remained untouched; alone. Amara explained:

"This is the beginning of Samadhi; the Savikalpa Samadhi. Here, the awareness of two separate identities exists - that is, of yourself and of the surrounding world. As you advance, the awareness transcends. You will become aware of your Divine essence and the Divinity surrounding you. Then, from mere awareness, to actually experiencing and becoming the Divinity in you and also relating to the Divinity surrounding you at deeper levels, the consciousness in us expands. This stage of Samadhi can be described as Dwaita. Dwaita means two. Adwaita means not-two; but one. Adwaita is the next stage. Here, the awareness of yourself and God vanishes and the awareness of the entire existence as one, remains. This is the state of 'Aham Brahmasmi'. You are God. This is the state of Nirvikalpa Samadhi, where real Yoga occurs."

"Will I be able to achieve Nirvikalpa Samadhi in this life?"

"Yes! But don't think it is that easy. It is easy for you because you had advanced much in Sadhana in the previous life."

"Then, does it mean that we carry over our accomplishments to the next life?"

"Yes. Look at the child prodigies. They would have achieved something in the previous life. When they are born again for some reason that we cannot understand now, their brain cells remain open to the memories of the previous achievements. Then they begin recognising Ragas in music or start painting, even when they are just children."

"What about the achievements of people whose brain cells are closed?"

"They may not manifest early. They remain as inner urges and we will pick up the threads somehow, and pursue our interests of the past life at an appropriate time in our life."

"Where do all the memories remain in us?"

"In the mind. The mind is a big store-house. It has several chambers to hold memories, energies, recordings of Karmas etc."

"But why is our awareness limited to the memories of the present only?"

"It is for our own good. Memories of the past interfere and disturb the present life. That is why they are shut off. But people with psychic powers can recall. They can also look ahead into the future, like Nostradamus. The Rishis can look back into any number of our past lives or look ahead into thousands of years of our future."

"The past has already happened. It can be seen. The future is yet to take place. How can the future be seen?"

"The future also has happened! It is difficult to explain now. Time is like a river. From this point of time, we can see the future."

"If the future has already happened, then what is the point in struggling and planning now?"

"There are lessons in the struggle that help our spiritual evolution. That is why the future is shut off."

"If we learn the lessons now, then what about the future? Should we go through it?"

"No. Then our future changes. It is like shifting from one track to another. That is why spiritualisation is so important. We can change our future; change our destiny."

"What is my destiny?"

Amara smiled. There was a golden aura around him.

"Your destiny is with the Rishis."

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One day, we were watching a movie in a theatre. Suddenly, there was a flash. There was a telepathic communication from the Rishis. I whispered to my wife who was sitting next, "I received a message from the Rishis. They want me for their work. We may have to part." My wife turned and looked at me in the darkness. After a moment, she whispered back, "Are you drunk!"

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During April 1981, a music program was arranged to raise fund for our future activity. Amara gave permission and remained present in the meetings of volunteers, but he did not give any instructions directly. He said: "I will just sit as a witness. I want to see how you manage."

There were too many voices. I remained in the background.

On the day of the program, we were decorating the platform and arranging things. There was a lot of confusion and disarray.

And then, there was a flash. Someone was telling me to do something about the work. Pushing my shy nature aside, I stood up and gathered all the volunteers near and gave clear instructions about each individual's part and position. I was surprised at my own boldness. The program went off well.

After the program, we all gathered on the lawns of the music hall to take flights in the glory of success. I again had a flash. This time, it was clear. Markandeya Maharshi was instructing me telepathically to stand up and speak. I hesitated only for a moment. Then I stood up and addressed the small gathering of volunteers. I emphasized the necessity of organisation in our work and cohesion in executing it. I pointed out the plus points in such an approach. There were claps and admiration.

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In the first week of May, Amara announced that he would open an Ashram in his land, Manovati. He invited volunteers to join. I wanted to join. I discussed it with my family who, naturally, did not agree. I discussed it with Amara who did not accept my proposal, readily. I studied the implications, worked out several plans and finally suggested that I would take voluntary retirement from my job in the central government and support my family from outside. Amara assured me of all help in times of need. He also explained:

"This is not going to be an Ashrama of the conventional type and you are not going to be a sanyasi. You may visit your family every week and take care. You have to forget the Ashrama when you are with your family and forget your family when you are in the Ashrama. You will come to Manovati for your individual Spiritual growth and collective Spiritual work; we have to prepare the place for great Spiritual projects."

This sudden invitation for a great Spiritual project attracted a few other Meditators also. Finally we were five. I took retirement and obtained reluctant consent from my family - my wife and my two children.

Amara asked us to meet him on May 18, 1981. It was my birthday. We were sitting around Amara on that glorious summer morning. Amara appeared, for a moment, as excited as we were. He spoke in his majestic voice:

"There is a Rishi here, Sagara Maharshi. He is very great. This is a great moment. You have been chosen for a very great work which will take place once in fifty-one thousand years. Markandeya Maharshi selected you during the music program work. Now, I want you to take an oath in the presence of Sagara Maharshi."

He explained and we took the oath. Then, he went into his room and brought out a key and holding the key in his hand, he said:

"This is the key to the building in Manovati. There is only one key and you are five. To whom shall I hand over the key?"

The others began discussing and I was aware, at that moment, that the key carried many responsibilities. The key was a symbol. Quickly, the others decided that I, being the eldest, should receive the key. I had not expected it. There was a sudden alertness in me that expanded my awareness. I realised that it was a great moment in my life. Amara looked at me intently and handed over the key saying: "You know what this is!" I said: "Yes, I know!"

With this, I realised that it was another birth for me; another birthday.

Amara instructed:

"Go to Manovati now and stay there for the night. You may return to the city in the morning to collect your things and go back. At six in the evening, sit in a circle and meditate for seven minutes. The Sapta Rishis will come and initiate you into the Ashrama. I will come and meet you tomorrow."

We reached Manovati in the afternoon and meditated at six in the evening for seven minutes. During the Meditation, I experienced strong energies entering me. I knew I had been initiated into a new life; a new phase in my life.

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That evening was very beautiful and the night was very pleasant. We roamed the entire land during the night, oblivious of the snakes. We talked, laughed and dreamed of our glorious life in Manovati. In the morning, we woke up early and returned to the city. When I went home, my daughter began crying. She said: "You have gone to an Ashrama. You have left me." I was stunned. I did not know how to face this reality. I held my tears back. I loved my family. Although I would be visiting them and would not sever contacts, I realised that I was a different person now. I belonged to Manovati. I was confused for a moment. I wondered if I had taken the right decision. I decided not to think and reason at that time. I realised how difficult it was to take big strides without hurting someone; without hurting ourselves. But I did not regret joining Manovati, at that time or at any time. I realised that I had to transcend the human level.

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Amara visited us the next day. He was very happy to see us there in that uninhabited and uncultivated expanse of land. He invited us to sit around him in the evening, after he had spent an hour inside the room alone, invoking the Sapta Rishis and gods. In

a diary, he drew a Swastika over an Om with seven stars below them and said: "This is your emblem." He also gave us new names.

He called me Krishnananda.

He explained:

"The Ashrama is an internal affair. For others, this is something like a farm. You have come from Bangalore to develop this place. You will continue your Sadhana intensely and take up agricultural work as occupation."

"Why agriculture?"

"Because you will spend more time with nature. The money you earn will not be tainted. More than anything, you will have to depend on God for rains and crops. Agriculture will become a part of your Sadhana."

We followed his instructions and jumped into activity. I was made the leader. I did not know about agriculture. I met the villagers and took their help and advice. Amara arranged a loan for our work. We grew Ragi that year. It was a bumper harvest and people from the surrounding villages began visiting Manovati just to look at the crop. People praised our efforts. Amara was happy.

One day, when he visited, I gave him a piece of Papaya. Amara held it in his hand for a long moment and then said:

"I have waited fifty years for this!"

He saw much more than the fruit. I wanted to present him more fruits and much more.

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We used to meet Amara more often, before coming to Manovati, in Bangalore. Now, we missed the narration of his works and many things that he explained. When we mentioned this to

him, he remarked: "You don't know what the people in Bangalore are missing!"

He wanted us to build a friendly base with the villagers. There were several villages around Manovati at a distance of about a kilometre each. I moved around, met the villagers and tried hard to establish contacts with them. I was fairly successful. It took some time for them to accept us as harmless neighbours and not a bunch of picnickers who had come there to stay for a few days, playing cards and drinking liquor.

Once, a ferocious looking hefty villager came to our monthly medical camp run by Mrs. Amara. He got angry when the doctor did not attend to him immediately. His ego was piqued. He went away abusing the doctor and everyone. After a few days, I met him on my way to bus stop in the nearby village. I remembered Amara's words: "Establish a friendly base." I wanted to befriend him. I greeted him. He recognised me quickly and showered the choicest abuses! It was not easy to smile and move on, but I did that. I met him again there, after some days. I smiled again and greeted him. He did not fail to abuse! This went on again and again, but I did not give up.

One day, on my way, as usual to the bus stop, I saw him talking with some other villagers. I did not want to disturb him. I moved on. He must have seen me walking away. He called out! I was surprised to see him smiling at me. He enquired if I was going to the bus stop. I said "yes." He joined me. We walked in awkward silence. And then, suddenly, he opened up. He said that he had not meant to hurt me; it was the doctor who had insulted him! I apologised on behalf of the doctor and invited him for tea. He promptly came to Manovati, the next day. And we became friends!

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Amara visited us regularly, enquired about our welfare like an anxious parent but did not give us detailed instructions about our work and living there. He had given us the principles. But there were so many details and it was not easy to manage and deal with other people. I had difficulties. They were too trivial to be taken to Amara. But they were like thorns that I could not ignore. I chose to link up to him mentally and seek his guidance. Amara guided me every time. But once, when I contacted him telepathically for a clarification, he told me: "I can explain to you. But how long will you go on like this? You must get used to taking independent decisions; commit mistakes and learn. I want you to shine with your own light." I followed his instructions.

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Once I heard our dog barking continuously. I went out and saw a cobra entering a pile of wood. I called out for a labourer and instructed him to drive it out. He hesitated and brought another person. That person tried to drive out the cobra. It did not move. Then, before we could realise what he was doing, he had killed it. I did not know if we had committed a grave mistake by killing a life. If it was a mistake, what was the next thing to do, to atone? When I met Amara the next time, I asked him about it. He explained:

"It was neither right nor wrong. You are living in their area. You must learn to co-exist. I will talk to that soul and help it."

A person who knew Amara well, once narrated an incident to us. Years ago, a huge cobra was living with Amara! People were scared in the beginning. Then, they got used to its fearsome presence. Many had seen Amara playing with it. One day, it was playing with the neighbour's dog. The neighbour thought it was attacking his pet and he shot it down. When I mentioned this, Amara explained:

"That was a special soul. For some reason, it had to take birth as a cobra. After the cobra got killed, it went to the Rishis. The Rishis helped the soul and now it is living as a boy. I have met him physically. He does not remember what had happened to him. I did not tell him."

"Is it true that we first take birth as animals and then evolve to human beings?"

"No. We are from Parabrahma Loka. We are always born as humans. The souls in the bodies of plants, trees, birds and animals are all created at a lower Divine plane. After death, they go back to their plane and that is their Mukti. They are not bound by Spiritual laws like the laws of Karma, as we are bound. They are bound by a different set of laws. Once in fifty-one thousand years, they are allowed to take birth, once, as human beings and experience life. These people live amongst us. If you carefully observe, perhaps, you can make out. If you meet them astrally, you can easily make out."

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It was November 1981. We started harvesting a part of the Ragi crop. I had hired a labour force of nearly twenty people. By noon, a drizzle threatened disruption of the work. It did not stop but intensified. I learnt, it was due to a depression near Madras and that it would continue for a few days more. The villagers apprehended damage to the harvested crop. It was our first harvest. A loss would affect us. When I was struggling with my confused thoughts of loss and helplessness, I remembered Amara's words: "You have to depend on God."

I entered the Meditation room and sat before the statue of Lord Krishna there. I prayed for help. The drizzle and occasional rains

continued for three days. But in our area, only a very light drizzle, occasionally, came down although heavy dark clouds passed over, almost continuously! We worked all the three days. There was no damage. After completing the work, I went to Lord Krishna again and thanked him profusely with uncontrollable tears and emotions. After some time, I heard heavy rain lashing outside and it continued for the next two days! I did not speak about this to anyone. I mentioned this to Amara. He said:

"God always responds. But we do not approach him with faith. And when he helps, we do not recognise it. Our Rishis also noticed your difficulty. They also have helped here. Thank them. You have done a sincere job. They will help you."

One day, one of the inmates woke me up in the night and took me outside and said: "Look, there is a cloud there!" On close observation, I noticed a small thin cloud descending. It soon covered our land where we had crops standing and then disappeared. He said, he had seen it daily from nearly a month. When we spoke about this, the other inmates laughed and joked. But Amara said: "Rishis are helping you."

We had a bumper crop!

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On one of his visits, Amara saw a table cloth that I was using, stared at it for long and then remarked:

"The picture of Lord Krishna explaining his message, the Gita, on this cloth has a message for you also. First, this place is a battleground. Then you have to turn to God. He will guide you."

Manovati was really a battleground. The expenditure grew and the income did not match it. Each one of the inmates had his own ways; I had to battle with the egos. I had a battle within. I could not

devote more time to Meditations; I had a lot of work on the farm. I missed my family; but I could never think of going back. I had strictly followed Amara's instructions. I had burnt my boats.

I had to fight on several fronts. I did not have enough strength.

Then, I turned to God. I sought His help. In Meditations and prayers I tried to reach Him.

Amara stood aside and watched.

Vijayadashami of 1981 was an important day. Amara had asked us to meditate more and wait. We meditated and spent the whole day in anticipation of something great happening. In the night, we had glimpses of many Rishis, Amara and a very bright light. The next day, when we met Amara, he narrated:

"You have a very great work ahead. You require enormous strength and a lot of money. They won't come easily. So, the Rishis prayed to God and have brought a special power. It is in the form of a huge ball of light. They brought it down from the higher plane yesterday night and have placed it under the ground of the building where you are staying now. Many Rishis joined their work. Lord Krishna has blessed it. Now, you can tune up to its vibrations by Meditations, daily, and draw energies which will bring you all the necessary help."

I assured Amara that with such Divine help, I would build up the Ashrama as next to none. Amara looked at the sky with contemplative eyes. We sat in silence for a long time. Then he spoke:

"Do not think that this is our Ashrama. The whole world is our Ashrama. This power is for all. The Rishis' work is for everyone's welfare - both Spiritual and Material. That is why our work is difficult and great. This work does not end with me or you. This has

to continue for four more generations. The forces of Pralaya will start acting soon. There will be confusion and chaos. There will be many false prophets as mentioned in the Bible, many misleading cults and many dark people will become active. People sink into depths of unhappiness, inspite of material affluence. Then from this centre of the Sapta Rishis, light should go out and guide people clearly in the path towards God; towards Truth, Perfection and Peace. It is not an easy task. It is a very responsible work."

"Do not think, you have come here by chance. You were destined to come. It was arranged even before you took birth. Be proud that you had started this work of Rishis even in the last cycle, that is, fifty-one thousand years ago! We have been doing this in every cycle."

"Never give up this work, whatever the compulsion is. All types of difficulties will come in the way. It is natural. It is never easy to climb Mount Everest! So, you must anticipate great obstacles. Your faith will help. The Rishis will help. Now, they cannot come down yet. After some decades, they will take birth and continue their work in this plane. Now, they need channels and mediums like us."

"Do not ever allow your ego to dominate. Whenever a person allows his ego to rule, the Rishis will send him away. Nobody is an exception including you."

I etched every word he spoke on the rock of memory.

Suddenly, huge doors opened before me. Everything expanded. My life, my goal, my dreams, my visions, my horizons, my skies....Everything expanded.

SEVEN

We entered 1982.

I thought I could meditate more in Manovati. But I could not. The work demanded all attention and more time. It was not just growing crops. It was relating to people, understanding them and establishing contacts with their positive part. I could build up a good labour force. I treated them with kindness, helped them in their needs and made efforts to improve their quality of living. I gave them uniforms and caps to wear in the sun, sat with them to discuss the work, took advice in choosing crops and, more than anything, made them feel responsible and trustworthy. I gave them my whole-hearted love. The result was wonderful. They did more work and loved the work.

My Meditations gave me strength and direction; gave me patience and insight. Meditations, inter-action with the beautiful part of the labour and growing along with the crops, brought enormous changes in me. I did not miss the beautiful sunsets and glorious moonrises. I spent hours in solitude, visualising the future activity in Manovati. I remembered, constantly, Amara's words, as we were walking together on the green grass, "I want a paradise to come up in Manovati!" I dreamed in daylight and bathed in moonlight.

I could not share much of these things, unfortunately, with the other inmates. They were too young and had not suffered much in life. My family got used to my absence during the week. My

financial assistance continued. My wife took care of my children. Everything appeared to be going on well.

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A Meditator had a strange vision. In the vision, he had seen the birth of a baby-boy. The baby-boy was glowing with very bright light. It smiled at him and spoke to him. But he did not remember the words.

Most of the time, when people narrated their experiences, Amara smiled and remained silent. But when he heard about this vision, he beamed with a strange excitement, which was very unusual. His voice was unusually trembling as he spoke:

"I must tell you this. The Mahavatara has taken birth!"

We waited eagerly to know who the Mahavatara was?

"We have heard of the ten Avataras of Maha Vishnu. We do not know that one more Avatara comes down to earth, at the end of every cycle."

"But this is not mentioned anywhere! Nobody knows!"

"Nostradamus mentions about a boy who will rule the earth. We have lost most of the records. The Vedas, Upanishads and Puranas available now are only a part."

"How were they lost?"

"Ravages of time. Human negligence. As Kali Yuga advanced, people lost their capacities to understand them and follow. False knowledge and long rituals to earn money were introduced. But we will get back all the knowledge and much more. Our shift into the New Age, into the new Consciousness and into the new cycle of time will remove all the pettiness in us and make us the Spiritual giants that we are, when we can gather all these."

"What is the purpose of the Mahavatara?"

"He will restore the Spiritual balance. Lord Kalki will force the change. This may cause suffering and destruction. Then Mahavatara will take over the process. He will be carrying with him energies from the highest plane. He will release these energies and help people to enter into the new Consciousness. He is the one who will establish the Kingdom of God."

Amara gave more details about the Mahavatara.

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Whenever someone asked Amara about any great person, he would reveal his original identity. But whenever we asked who Ramakrishna Paramahansa was, he said, he did not know! I had a growing suspicion that Amara himself was Ramakrishna. Once, I asked him: "Are you Ramakrishna?" Amara said emphatically, "No" without any hesitation. But, somehow, I did not accept this. One day someone asked him again: "Who was Ramakrishna?" He replied promptly: "I don't know." At that time, I told myself that he did not want to reveal about himself. He must have heard my thoughts. Suddenly, he turned towards me with a smile and said: "I have not come across him. So, I don't know." But I was not convinced.

Once day I had a vision. I saw Ramakrishna Paramahansa. I bowed to him. When I raised my head, I saw Amara standing in his place! I was convinced, now, that Amara was Ramakrishna. Amara himself must have given me this vision. But when I met him the next time and told him about this, he just smiled and said: "It is just a vision!"

I realize now, the identity of a Master is not very important. They all come from the Divine plane. Each Master manifests his Divinity

in his own way and for a purpose. They should never be gauged by the human measures and should never be compared to anyone else. Each one is a light by himself; each one, a doorway.

I do not really know if Amara was Ramakrishna Paramahansa. I did not speak about my vision to anyone.

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Amara fell ill in April 1982. He had problems with his kidneys, heart and had blood pressure. He was bedridden. One day, when I went to see him, he could not get up from his bed. We were all used to meeting him in the verandah or the hall in his newly built house in Koramangala extension. Always clean-shaven, neatly attired and upright in walking and sitting, Amara was a personification of strength and majesty. And now, looking at his unshaven face, I felt very sad and did not know what to say. I sat by the side of his bed, silently, having lost my inner poise and words to express my inner stirrings.

Quite some time passed. I composed myself and suddenly asked him:

"No one will ask you this question but I am very deeply attached to you. You are my Spiritual father. Please tell me when are you leaving your body? I want some time to prepare myself."

No one would have asked such a question at any time. It was not easy for me. But I wanted to know!

Amara knew everything. I expected him to answer straightaway and so, I waited. But he remained silent. From his upturned face, I saw tears rolling down! At that time, I could not understand my own emotions. I realised, later on, that I had not expected tears from him. All the time, we had forgotten that he was also human; he also had emotions, feelings and sentiments.

We always looked at him as a mountain of strength and an ocean of courage. Undoubtedly, he was all that. But he was also human. Perhaps, every Avatara wept and laughed; joked and sulked. Puranas have not recorded the human part of the Divine personalities. Once, a human body is donned, every great soul would have to, perhaps, go through the human emotions, though at the surface.

Amara was no ordinary Master. I cannot write about many great works that he did and about the great powers that he employed only for accomplishing a task set by the Rishis and for serving others. But I shall mention only one: During the second world war, Amara had materialised himself at eighteen different places in eighteen different bodies, at the same time, and had worked for the Red Cross, carrying bodies and tending the wounded. And, he had never spoken about this. We learnt about this from his family members, during a casual talk.

After a long silence, Amara spoke without looking at me:

"I don't know. The Rishis decide about such things."

After clearing my throat and in a shaky voice, I said:

"I am sorry. I should not have asked about it."

He looked at me and smiled; he spoke with inexplicable warmth and immeasurable affection:

"I too would have asked, in your place!"

I asked him:

"What is the mission in your life? Have you accomplished it?"

"I have come to establish the Rishis' centre on this earth. That is my mission. For that, I had to gather all of you together. I think I have done that."

"How did you trace us?"

"Everything is monitored from the Astral plane. Everything is known. All that I had to do was to will, using my thought force that all of you gather here. And you are all here!"

"Could anyone resist your call?"

"Yes. You see, the call was a reminder of your promise. You had promised to work for the Rishis. You could have ignored the call. There is freedom at all levels. Nothing is imposed."

"Did anyone ignore the call?"

"Yes. Some ignored."

"What happens to them? Will they be punished?"

"They have lost the opportunity. The Rishis do not punish anyone. For the violation of Spiritual laws, people attract Karmas and suffer."

"Now that we have gathered here and Manovati has come to life, what exactly are we required to accomplish?"

"First, you have to grow and shine like Rishis. I expect 144 Meditators to rise, because we have 1,44,000 channels on earth. If not, I expect seven to shine. If not, at least, one. If no one rises to the expectations of the Rishis, I shall leave my body with the satisfaction that I have done my job. And the Rishis will send out one more call. Others may come. If not they, some others."

"Will you return to earth afterwards?"

"Yes. I will come back in 2042. You will also come back again. We have to work in this project for five life-times."

I returned to Manovati with a calm mind, though many thoughts were flooding me.

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One day, Amara sent a message to us.

"There is going to be a nuclear war on June 10, 1982. It will begin at 10 AM and within 12 minutes, the war will be over, leaving two-thirds of the world's population dead."

I rushed to him and asked him for instructions.

"Go ahead with your normal activities. Go ahead with your Sadhana. Meditate more, if possible. Do not panic. Do not speak about this to anyone. Just anchor yourself in God and wait."

The war did not take place! It is funny to recall that we felt disappointed! If the war had not taken place, there must have been some reason. I rushed to Amara, again.

"The Rishis got it postponed. They used their thousands of years of Tapas-Shakti for this. They do not want so much of loss of life."

"Who will decide about such things?"

"God."

I wanted to know more.

"Have you seen God?"

"It is difficult to answer such questions. I have met the Divine personalities like Lord Shiva and Maha Vishnu. I have experienced Parabrahma who has no form. But I have not gone to His core. If I go there and come back, millions of years would have elapsed by that time, here on this plane."

"You have experienced God. Can you describe it?"

"It is difficult; it is beyond words. Imagine millions of galaxies exploding, millions of galaxies taking birth, innumerable souls entering in and going out; imagine thousands of coloured lights; imagine great peace and love encompassing all these....imagine all these occurring simultaneously. If you experience all these

simultaneously, you will have experienced a tiny fraction of Him!"

I stretched my imagination to its limits. Then I realised that we had to go beyond all imagination, all thoughts, to experience Him.

"When will the war take place?"

"I don't know. The Sapta Rishis are performing a Yagna in the Himalayas. If they succeed, the war may even be cancelled. But, they have been doing Yagnas from several years. They have been successful only in postponing the war, so far. You see, the humanity also has to awaken and follow the Spiritual values. Then only, the war can be averted."

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Amara's condition did not improve. Vishwamitra Maharshi began visiting him during nights and treating him. After a few days, his health improved. But, again, it worsened. Amara explained to us about this:

"Vishwamitra Maharshi was puzzled. Then one night, he keenly observed and found a tiny black object in my stomach. He realised that it was the cause of the repeated reversals in my health condition. He removed it and then, that very tiny object took the form of a person. He apologised to the Rishi, saying that he had been sent by a dark person under whom he was working. He had been instructed to hide in my system, damage my body and finally destroy it. He was only obeying his master. Vishwamitra Maharshi asked him to go away. He said, he was doing his duty. Then he continued the treatment."

Amara's health improved dramatically. But it was only for a short time! The cause was traced, this time to Karmas. Amara had taken over the Karmas of many people who had come to him with their problems. He had to suffer for them. We knew that he could

have burnt out the Karmas. But he had chosen to go through them. He said, the powers should not be wasted for such trivialities! He was ready to suffer! Once the Karmas got cleared, he would be alright. We waited for that. But he had to go through great pain, meanwhile. We did not know what to do!

I met Amara after a week. I saw a big smile on his face. He was waiting for me to narrate something!

"Two days ago, in the evening, I was lying down with unbearable pain. There was no one in the house. Then I heard the sound of a flute. It came through the window. I thought that it must have been from a transistor radio. But the sound came nearer and nearer. And suddenly, I saw Lord Krishna standing near my cot! He had materialised for me! I wanted to get up but could not. Krishna sat down on the cot. Then He moved His hand over my body, from head to foot and said: "I have burnt out all the Karmas. I have removed all your pain. You should not suffer!" All my pain vanished in that moment. I got up. Krishna embraced me and then vanished."

"This is the greatest moment in my life!"

I looked at him and wondered: "What a great person!" And I was sitting before him, had learnt from him and had spent my best years with him. I touched his feet.

In the silence that followed, we did not check the flow of tears that came down.

Any beautiful moment cannot last long. Capturing that moment in our hearts forever, we woke up to the reality. I had to catch the last bus! While parting, Amara said:

"Now all my Karmas are cleared. I will live for seventeen years."

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Amara's health worsened again! I did not understand. I went to meet him on the morning of August 25, 1982. Mrs. Amara told me: "He is very weak and cannot even talk. I would not have allowed anyone else into his room. But you are special. I want you to spend only one minute with him and come back. I shall be waiting here." And she stood behind the door, as I entered the room.

Amara saw me and suddenly got up and sat down! Although he could not see Mrs. Amara, he asked her to close the door and leave the place; he wanted to talk to me!

There was no trace of weakness or pain in him! Amara spoke for forty-five minutes. I have never revealed to anyone, what he had spoken in those forty-five minutes. He spoke with great passion and emotion. It was very much unlike him. I listened to him with such attention that the world around me faded out. Finally, he wanted me to bring the other inmates in the afternoon; he wanted to instruct them about certain things. I told him that, as he was not well, I would carry his instructions to them. But he insisted on speaking to them personally. So, I promised to bring them by the afternoon.

After speaking, Amara lay down, looking weak, as if the strength that he had drawn to speak with me had been thrown out. Before leaving, I assured him:

"I will follow every word of your instructions."

Amara whispered:

"It is not enough. I want everyone to follow!"

At that time, I did not know that those would be his last words. Before I returned in afternoon, he had passed away!



PART TWO

ONE

Amara continues to live in this book and in my life, after leaving his physical body.

TWO

1982-1985

The sudden absence of a person like Amara creates a vacuum that can never be filled up. The one dominant question in everyone's mind was: "Who will take us further now?" By now, there were about two thousand Meditators and more people were joining. The techniques from the beginning to the stage of Samadhi were, of course, available. But who would study and assess the progress? Who would modify and improve the techniques, to suit the individual, which becomes necessary particularly in the higher stages of Samadhi? Who would bring us instructions and messages from the Rishis? There was no one.

Amara had not named anyone as his successor. No one could occupy his place.

And yet, the work of teaching Meditation had to go on. The Sadhaks in Bangalore consulted his wife and chose a senior Sadhak to pass on the techniques, recorded earlier, to the beginners and also to those in different stages of Meditation. The Sunday gatherings in Bangalore for this purpose continued, as earlier.

We, in Manovati, had clear instructions about our work. We continued. Mrs. Amara extended the same love and care that Amara had showered on us.

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In a few months the other inmates left Manovati and went back to their previous life. I remained alone.

By now, I was conversant with the agricultural work. I had very good relations with the villagers and with the help of the workers, I could carry on my work with ease. The goodwill that Amara had earned for the place, helped me in gaining respect and confidence. The villagers always referred to Amara as the Belgaum Raja and used to narrate his noble qualities. He always greeted them with folded hands, spoke with kindness and respect and helped them in their times of need.

There were no proper roads to Manovati at that time. Amara used to park his car near a tank and walk to Manovati. He always carried two bags with him, each containing biscuits and distributed them to anyone he met on the way to Manovati and on his way back. It was not the biscuits that endeared him to the people, but it was his genuine affection towards them and his innate warmth of Love.

Consciously, I tried to continue the tradition of goodwill and affection. Mrs. Amara encouraged me in this direction. And very shortly, I became very popular. The villagers invited me to their school functions and annual jattras. They gave me the first invitation card for the wedding of their daughters and sons, before distributing to others. They did not recognise Manovati as a farm, but as a Spiritual Centre.

There was a small temple in a nearby village. Every year, the idol of the goddess was taken in procession in the village. Now, the procession first came to Manovati and after our offering the first Puja, it continued in the village. For me, it was a rare experience. Many accompanied the procession, singing and dancing, and spent more time in Manovati. I could see the procession, with the

dazzling lights and beating drums coming slowly towards Manovati in the cool hours of the early night and again moving away slowly, with great delight.

People conducted marriages near our Ashwatha Katte, a huge platform built around sacred trees. They came for medicine, sometimes, when they had fever or headache.

Once, I had an interesting experience. A person came complaining of diarrhoea. I explained to him that I was not a doctor and advised him to go to a doctor, in the other village. He was persistent in taking the medicine from me! Then, I took some blank globules from the Homoeopathic medicine chest, prayed to God and Amara and gave it to him, telling him repeatedly to go to the doctor, if he did not find relief. Strangely, when I met him after two days, he was alright! I was certain that Amara must have cured him with his healing powers. I was happy. But this brought a stream of patients and many blank globules in the medicine chest were used.

One day, a young mother came with her very young baby. She asked me to bless the baby and give a name. I was deeply stirred and struggled to decide about complying to her request. Living in the shadows of great men also widens our shrunken auras!

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I continued my Meditations. I was confident I had reached a stable ground in Sadhana. I was also confident that Amara, now in the Astral plane would somehow guide me further. I tried to contact him. I could not get his link. But I was not disappointed. I was certain that sooner or later I would establish contact with him.

One day, I was tired. The sun was very strong; the wind was still. I had a lot of paper-work to do. I decided to lie down and rest for a

while. I do not know if I had dozed off. Suddenly, I saw Amara standing near my cot. There was someone else with him whose form was very hazy and I could not make out. I heard Amara telling him: "He is very tired. I want to remove his tiredness." Then he passed his hand over my body, from my head to foot. My tiredness vanished that very moment. I got up from the bed. But Amara had disappeared.

I was touched by his concern and love. I had tears. Then I realised that it was for the first time, after his leaving the body that Amara had contacted me.

I did not speak about this to anyone. It was a very personal experience. It was not for others to know. Besides, some were already claiming that they could talk to Amara. I wanted this to be a secret and very sacred in my memory.

It was the first contact.

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Mrs. Amara was very good to me. She treated me like a son. And told me, one day, that after her death, I had to perform the last rites!

In all the years that I stayed at Manovati, she bought me clothes, bought clothes for my entire family, gave me money to spend and treated me like her own son. Her concern about my welfare was such that after a telephone was installed at Manovati, she instructed me to call her daily in the morning and report to her that I was alright! When Indira Gandhi was killed, she sent a TV from Bangalore to watch the funeral.

Once, I returned from Bangalore in the night, catching the last bus which reached the nearby village bus stop at about eleven. Manovati was more than a kilometer from the bus stop and I had

requested one of our labourers to wait for me. Three of them were waiting for me when I got down from the bus. It was very pleasant to walk in the cool dark night, chatting with them. When we reached Manovati, one of them observed that when I alighted from the bus, another person also got down and was following us at a distance. But he could not see him now. Where had he gone? Suddenly, they became alert and began searching for the person but they could not find him. We presumed, then, that he must have gone back to the village but could not understand his following us at that time of the night.

The next day, even before the sunrise, I heard the sound of a car. Then someone was pounding my door. I opened the door and saw Mrs. Amara standing! She heaved a sigh of relief after looking at me and enquired how I was. She explained that she had a dream the previous night. In the dream, she had seen me alighting from a bus in the night. Another person had also alighted. He followed me and on the way, attacked me with a chopper. When she woke up, she realised that I had left for Manovati from Bangalore in the night. She had come there to see me!

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Life at Manovati was not simple and smooth. I had problems. But we always have problems in any area or in any field. In addressing the problems, we grow; we learn; we mature.

Initiating people into Meditation and into higher stages of Meditation was stopped in Bangalore and started at Manovati. People began visiting Manovati on Sundays. We arranged food and tea for them. Every Sunday was like a festival day for us. More than a hundred visited us every Sunday and I felt the strain on my purse. I did not ask for help from anyone and decided to earn more

from farming. I struggled and managed. But the strain was much. I incurred loans, cleared them and again incurred.

With people, problems also come like everywhere else. I did not enter into controversies, disputes or clashes of ego. For me, the work was more important than the persons. And everyone was also interested in the work; wanted Manovati to grow and shine. Sometimes, our approaches were different and the egos were very tall.

I cannot forget one funny incident. Amara had clearly instructed us not to worship him, at any time. He had given the examples of Masters whose statues are now ritualistically worshipped with specially composed Ashtottaras but their teachings are not understood and not followed. He had wanted us to follow the principles he had explained; not just worship him.

On Sundays, we used to put a garland of flowers on the photo of Amara, out of respect and affection. A person objected to this saying, we were violating Amara's instructions. We were worshipping him! I did not accept his argument. I explained the difference between our expression of love and the ritual worship. But he did not agree and created a scene. Mrs. Amara pacified him.

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We used to observe a pink light in the eastern horizon more often those days. Amara had explained this as an indication of the Rishis doing some work at Manovati, at the Astral level. Whenever, I saw the light, I tried to sit in Meditation and tried to see the Rishis. But I did not see them.

I saw many times, a thin cloud silently descending on Manovati, during the nights, and disappearing into the crops. I realised that

the Rishis were helping us to get a good yield. I remembered Amara's words: "If you want a good crop, go and meditate in the field. The vibrations generated by your Meditations will bring good results." I tried this. I do not know how much I succeeded. But, we always had good crops and higher yields.

We celebrated Amara's birthdays and observed his death anniversaries. On these days, we invited the school children, gave them food and gifts. People sang Bhajans and we all meditated.

I realised that communication amongst the group was very important. I began publishing a Newsletter, and named it "Manovati Patra", a letter from Manovati. It was received very well. I published various experiences of Meditators with Amara, rare information that Amara had given us and articles on Yoga and Meditation.

I wanted to write a book on Amara, after gathering information from some of his friends still alive. Mrs. Amara bought me a Tape Recorder to record their talks. I met them and planned the recordings.

Meanwhile, I had not neglected my family. I regularly visited them. My wife co-operated very well. She took care of all the family welfare - education of our children, managing the house, paying bills etc. For my part, I gave money from my pension and a part of the pocket money from Manovati.

Everything was fine.

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During August 1984, a few days after Janmashtami, the birthday of Lord Krishna, I had a long Astral experience that I can never forget. As I look back now, every detail comes back to my mind, as if in a film replayed.

Lord Krishna appeared and asked me to follow him. He was wearing a yellow dhoti. His chest was covered by necklaces with dazzling stones. He wore a crown studded with huge diamonds and other coloured stones. He looked so magnificent and beautiful that he could never be captured on any canvas.

We walked on an unknown road with huge trees on either side. After sometime we sat down on the grass. He explained to me many things for a long time. I did not remember anything of that when I woke up. But I remembered his words: "Stick on to the place. Don't go away." I did not understand. I listened to Him. I was surprised at the familiarity with which I spoke to Him and moved with Him. We talked and walked like very close friends.

Then, Krishna took me to an unknown place. It was full of trees. There was a huge pond with stone steps. A very well-built man was sitting by the side of the pond. He was doing Tapas. Krishna pointed to him and said: "This is Arjuna. When Vishwamitra Maharshi hurled the power he brought from God into the sky, Arjuna was near the explosion and was hit by the waves of energy. He was unable to bear the burning pain. I asked him to sit here and do Tapas. He listens to me always. You will meet him in your next life."

I looked at Arjuna again and admired his grace and majesty.

Krishna took me to another place. It was a huge building. We entered the building. Krishna went to a door and knocked. A lady's voice from inside asked who it was? Krishna repeated his name. And the door was suddenly thrown open. A young lady, who must have been bathing, came running without caring to even put on a cloth and embraced Krishna. He turned towards me and smiled.

Krishna took me to some more places and explained many

things but I did not remember anything.

I wanted to note down my experiences in a note book. Then, I decided not to. I wanted to keep them in my memory.

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It was 1985; April.

In a specially prepared place, about twenty workers were busy separating Ragi from the husk. They were singing and joking. I was enjoying the whole activity, standing at a distance. Then, there was a big noise under the ground. I saw our entire building rising and sitting back with a thud. It took some time for us to realise that it was an earth tremor.

Strange things were brewing up in Bangalore. People who visited Manovati, whispered amongst themselves, throwing puzzling stares at me. Suddenly, people moved to distances. A person very close to Amara called me aside, one day, and said: "Are you blind? People are carrying tales to Mrs. Amara against you!"

It was unbelievable! I could not understand why! Was it jealousy? Suspicion? Conspiracy? These were the things not expected here. I waited till the mystery opened up. Then one day, I was summoned to a group meeting of influential Sadhaks and several accusations were hurled at me. I was not given an opportunity to explain or to defend myself. But I was confident that giving up my career, building up Manovati and my dedication to work were a rock-like foundation that could not be shaken by any tremor.

But, one day, when I returned to Manovati from Bangalore, I found a new lock on my door! A villager who was waiting for me began weeping loudly!

I could not collect any of my things. I gathered all my dreams and visions in the sweep of a single moment, did not wipe the escaping tears and walked out of Manovati.

THREE

1985-1987

Out of place and out of grace, I had a lot of time to reflect. I asked myself many questions repeatedly - What went wrong? What mistake did I make? Did I fail my Guru in any way? Did I violate any Spiritual law? I could not understand the reasons that precipitated this situation. It was easy to blame some persons and allow bitterness and abhorrence to rise and roar. But I realized that it was I who was naive. Mere idealism was not enough. I should have combined it with realism. I should have learnt to be cautious. I should not have incurred loans all by myself. Now, along with my dreams, I also had huge debts to clear.

I missed Amara. He would have understood me. I tried to contact him. When I could not succeed, I thought that he too had deserted me. Then, one day, when I was meditating, I heard a voice. It was very familiar. It was Amara! He said: "Lie low and meditate."

Suddenly, I got back all the confidence and hope. Amara was with me! I did not bother about the world that was not with me. I did not stir out of my house, did not try to meet or contact anyone and did not even think about the next step. I just waited and meditated.

After a week, a villager came searching for me. He requested me to visit his village which was just a kilometre from Manovati. I

thought that he must have had some problem or a dispute to settle. When I went to his village, he took me to all the lands he owned near the village and asked me to choose any piece and have it! His words are still in my memory. He said: "Please stay here and bring light to this village!"

I was very much touched by his affection and also realised that the Rishis were helping me. But I had no money to buy the land and could not accept it free. We discussed it for some time and then came to an agreement. I would stay in his land and use it to grow vegetables for my livelihood and to clear debts; for some time. He said: "life-long." I said: "As long as God wills." I selected a two-acre piece of land which was at a distance from the village, aloof.

In just two weeks after being thrown out of Manovati, I had a place to live, near Manovati! I had an opportunity to work and clear my debts, a place to stay and meditate, within the radius of the Manovati Light!

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I had land but there was no water and there was no roof. I had to get a well dug and build a room to stay. Again I wanted money. I had to incur loans again and it was not easy to raise loans, as friends avoided me and strangers did not trust me. The villager arranged some money but my monetary situation reached its lowest in my life. I sold my watch, my books and everything that I could and got a well dug.

I have to record an incident here because it is through such gestures that Amara and the Rishis constantly assured me that they were with me, caring and helping.

My villager friend brought a water diviner to confirm the water-

source at a place that he had already marked. The water diviner firmly said that there was no water there. My friend was disappointed. He was very keen on digging the well in that spot. Then he asked for my opinion. I prayed to Amara and the Rishis and then asked him to dig the well there. It was a huge well; forty feet in diameter. The work began. More than thirty people began digging the well. After a month, we had touched a depth of nearly twenty-five feet. There was no trace of water. The villagers scared us that we will not find water. But we went ahead with the work. When the well was more than thirty feet deep, my friend was shaken by doubt. I assured him that we will get water. My faith was not shaken; at that time or at any other time!

Every foot after thirty feet brought sighs of despair and more disappointment. When we reached a depth of thirty-five feet and there was no trace of water still, all the villagers urged us to abandon the work saying, it was a waste. My friend also wanted to give it up. I requested him to continue the work to dig two more feet. He reluctantly agreed and the work went on. When we dug one more foot, suddenly, we found small traces of wetness and a little water in one or two places. One more foot and then the water gushed out! I was not surprised. The gush of my joy and gratitude was much more than the water.

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I had the land and then water. But I wanted more money to build a circular stone wall in the well and then to plant a crop. More money meant more loans; more difficulties. As I could not build a room in the land to stay, I was travelling from Bangalore every day to the village, staying in my house, with the family. Each day was a great struggle.

One day, I had no money but I had to go to the village. I walked

to the bus stop from the house, about five kilometres, and went near the bus. I could not get in. I had no money for the bus fare. My pocket was empty. Then, I saw a villager waving at me from within the bus. He shouted: "Don't buy the ticket. I have bought your ticket also." I went to the village!

After completing the work in the village, I wondered: "Now, how can I return to Bangalore!" And Bangalore was twenty-five kilometres away! There appeared to be no other choice than walking and I did not waste time in thinking. Walking was better than thinking, at that time!

After walking for nearly a kilometre, I met an old lady who recognised me, hurried towards me and gave a big tomato that she was carrying in her hands, flashing a toothless smile. She also spoke kind words about my walking in the hot sun and said: "God will help you." She knew about my plight. All the villagers knew, though no one spoke about it. Their mute glances and sympathetic smiles reminded me that the essential goodness on earth would always remain.

I walked about three kilometres, eating the tomato, wiping a tear unseen by others and thinking of the Rishis and reached the main road. Then someone called me. Another villager! He was rich and had purchased a new car that day. He wanted me to sit and travel in his car and bless it! He took me to Bangalore and left me at my doorstep!

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Everyone, including my family, thought that I would never recover from my financial downfall. My case was in no way different from that of millions of men in the history of the world, who had gone down with misfortune. I had lost respect and

affection from those around me. Without money, I had lost my rights to decency and dignity. Mutely, I accepted many indignities and before I could be thrown out of my house one day, I walked out of that house silently, without daring to bid good-bye and escaping shaming words. I carried a torn towel, my dress and some books. Of course, I carried all my dreams along with me.

I reached the village in the evening and stayed in small and old Shiva temple, near the land that I had taken over for farming. The villagers did not ask any questions. I did not explain anything to them. Somehow, they knew and I was also aware of it!

As the sun rose the next day heralding a new phase in my life, and as I was brushing my teeth outside, a lady from the village brought me a cup of hot tea. Someone brought me breakfast later and someone else brought me lunch in the afternoon. I had my dinner also! I had not asked anyone for these but accepted silently as if it was a natural event! I lived like this for nearly a year! And the love of the villagers continued undiluted.

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My first crop was bottle gourd. It did not fetch me much profit but it brought me much confidence. After some time, I got a small hut built and moved into it. Someone gave me a cot, adding luxury!

I had to go to Bangalore often to sell vegetables and to purchase things. Whenever I went out I left all my things, though they were not many, in the hut which had no door. Any one could have taken any of the things from the hut at any time, very easily. But not a thing was stolen.

With my first earning, I bought chairs for the school and sweets for the children. I gave vegetables that I grew to the villagers,

wrote letters for them, helped the children in their studies but carefully kept away from the village politics and personal quarrels. This brought me more respect. They used to see me meditating often. This enhanced the respect, adding an aura. No one disturbed me in any way.

I could not stay in the hut any longer as heavy rains poured and cold winds sent chills in the winter. With the help of the villagers, I built a small room with a tiled roof near the pump house and moved into it. Now, I could use an electric lamp to read. One more luxury! After some time, I bought a stove and some utensils and started cooking.

In the nights, I sat outside the room, under the stars and opened the box of my dreams. I wondered often: in which part of the sky did Amara live! He had not contacted me for months. But I was certain that he followed every move and knew everything.

The villagers were all admiration for my courage in staying alone and away from the village. Some of them had seen ghosts near my room. I began joking that I was also a ghost!

About thirty feet away from my room, a cobra lived in a hole. Many villagers had seen it and had warned me. I had not seen it. One day, as I was walking towards my room, I saw it coming from the other side. I stopped for a moment not knowing what to do. The cobra stopped and raised its hood. I told it mentally that I would not harm. I requested it to make way for me and move away. It looked at me for some time, without moving and then moved away, as if it heard every word of mine. Amara had explained to us that snakes, animals and birds were capable of reading our thoughts. It was easy to communicate to them!

One day, I was about to get into the bus near my village. Then I

felt someone pulling my kurta. A dog was holding the edge of my kurta by its teeth and was trying to pull. I recognised it. It was Bobby, from Manovati!

Bobby was a very affectionate dog that we had reared. I had a special attachment to it. It would accompany me to the other village from where I used to catch buses to Bangalore. It used to sit under my chair when I was reading or writing. I did not know how it had come to this village. I had no time to think as the bus was about to move. I asked my worker to buy a bun for it. As the bus was moving, I thought of Bobby; it looked very thin and sick.

I returned to my village, the next day. My worker told me that Bobby had gone back to Manovati after following the bus for some distance. It died in the evening. Bobby had come, perhaps, searching for me to say good-bye! Such touching events in our life will always remain fresh in our memory.

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When I look back at those years, I realise that I went through a severe test and also a kind of training. I am happy that those years, though they remain as a part of my memory, do not evoke any bitterness now. I am not angry about anything. I do not have any complaints. Those years prepared me for the work that I am doing now. The people involved happened to be pawns in a game. They did not know, perhaps, what they were doing.

I managed my small farm efficiently, read books and meditated. I began clearing loans and continued to dream under the stars. I dreamt about a commune where people would live as one, following all Spiritual laws. They owned nothing but they owned everything. They brought out the best in their lives and shared it with the others. People forgot about hating others. All the earnings

were pooled together. There was a common kitchen, a common store and a common Meditation hall.

I drew elaborate plans on paper and drew the sketches of the buildings. I drew plans of the Cosmic temple that Amara had been talking about. A huge eighteen storeyed temple representing eighteen different planes and the life there. The moon waxed and waned and the stars smiled. The darkness covered all the ugly spots on the earth and the sky opened up its bosom of unseen stars.

One night, in September 1987, as I was gazing into the familiar sky, I had a sudden revelation! In the light of the revelation, I saw that I had a very prominent role in the work of the Rishis. It was the Rishis who had pushed me into all the difficulties, testing my faith and convictions. I realised that I should not sit content with growing vegetables and dreaming projects. I had to begin work. But how?

A golden light that had descended from the sky enveloped me, revealing the mission in my life.

For days, I struggled to think of a way. Then, finally, one day, I decided to start Meditation classes.

FOUR

1988-1993

After deciding about starting Meditation classes, I thought very deeply about it. I wanted to continue Amara's work and not to open another branch. I found that none of his followers was teaching Meditation to others. I had come across a strong opinion in some of them when I was in Manovati, that there should be no initiations into the existing Meditators' group; no more followers. I had protested against this principle. The Spiritual knowledge and the Meditational techniques given by Amara, I believed, were not meant only for a group. It was meant for everyone who wished to take up Meditation.

For days, I hesitated about this step and could not easily get over the fear of embarrassing Mrs. Amara, whom I had always respected; I did not want to commit any mistake. After leaving Manovati, there had been no contact with anyone, not even with Mrs. Amara. So, I did the best thing that anyone could do at that time. I prayed to Amara and the Rishis and waited for a clear signal from them.

One night, when I was sitting outside my room, I suddenly saw a light in the hut which was not far away. I wondered who it was and went there. But there no one! I came back to my chair. Then, I saw the light in the hut again! I thought that it must be a signal from the Rishis. I tried to link up to Amara but he did not come in

contact. My intuition asserted that the light was the signal that I had been waiting for! But, I wanted more. The work that I was about to begin was not an ordinary one. I wanted to be very sure about the approval of my Masters -Amara and the Rishis. I prayed again.

The next day, around noon, as I came out of my room, I saw the same light in the hut again! It was very bright and moving! I did not wait any more. I was able to fix up a place for conducting the Meditation classes in Bangalore, shortly. I requested a Swamiji to inaugurate the classes. I printed cards and invited some old friends and VIPs to the inaugural function. I started the Meditation Classes in May 1988.

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Before starting the Meditation Classes, when I was contemplating on continuing Amara's work, I wanted to bring out a Newsletter, mainly, to disseminate the Spiritual knowledge from Amara. I wanted to build up a small group of supporters. I was searching for a name for this group. I wrote many names on paper and struck off many. I could not get any name that appealed to me.

One day, I was travelling in a bus to Bangalore. On the way, when I was looking at the sky there was a flash of light. In that flash of golden light, I saw a name shining -'Manasa'! I realised that this was the name given by the Rishis. I named the group 'Manasa Spiritual Foundation' and named the Newsletter 'Manasa Patra'.

February 1, 1988 was the birthday of Amara. I invited some friends to my hut. Seven persons came from Bangalore and we all meditated and started the 'Manasa Spiritual Foundation'. I printed the first issue of 'Manasa Patra' and got it released by a tiny girl, my friend's daughter who was just five years old! A dozen people had

gathered on the lawns of a shrine in the evening. It was March 1988. We asked the girl to untie a ribbon around a small bundle of the Newsletters, containing seven copies. She was playing with other children and was not interested in the 'release' of the Newsletter! Then, she responded to her mother's call, untied the ribbon hurriedly and went back to her play!

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I was one of the very few who had jotted down the rare points from the talks of Amara in the small groups that used to gather around him every day. Now, I went through all my notes, and worked for days to devise a course. When I stood, for the first time, before the group in the class of about fifty students who had enrolled I paused only for a moment with trepidation, till I was in strong link with Amara. Then it was not me but Amara who conducted the classes!

One day, when I was explaining a point from a chart that I had prepared, a person said that he saw a light coming out of the chart. As the weeks and months passed, people narrated their unusual experiences in the classes and during Meditations in their houses. The Meditators got various benefits - peace, memory, concentration, lessened anger and sublimation of other negative emotions etc. In the course of these ten years, I opened classes in three more centres. Hundreds joined the classes and many left. It was a flow. At any particular time, I had about a hundred students, whom I could meet personally and guide their Sadhana in all its details. This individual attention became a unique feature of this path.

In these ten years, I have experimented and developed new techniques, with the help and under the guidance of Amara and other Rishis. I developed the teachings and techniques from

Amara to a distinct path, the path of Rishis, Dhyana Yoga.

Amara was always present in the classes. Other Rishis also visited. As time passed, many Astral beings began gathering during the class-hours, to meet the Rishis and meditate along with our Meditators. On innumerable occasions, the student Meditators felt the presence of unseen visitors and some saw the hazy forms of the Rishis sitting on the platform. In spite of all these, the classes did not attract large numbers of people. Even while he was in his physical body, Amara used to say: "Let us not worry about the numbers. I prefer a few genuine Sadhaks to a crowd of curious visitors."

I came across very genuine and capable Sadhaks. Several of them could touch the borders of Samadhi easily; many could join us in Astral travels and some had the gifts of clairvoyance and other psychic capabilities. While teaching and guiding, I was also benefitted. I understood many points better. I could understand the difficulties of Sadhaks better and the limitations of the teachers. Consciously and sincerely, I made efforts to grow to carry on the growing work.

Meditation classes helped me more than the students!

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Once, a student came to me complaining of stomachache. He had been suffering from it for nearly a decade. He had tried medicines and doctors and had joined the Meditation classes in the hope of getting cured of his stomachache! This was something new for me to deal with. I prayed to Amara. He gave me a Mantra. I asked the student to repeat the Mantra daily and meet me after two months. After two months, there was no stomachache! Amara explained to me that he had been suffering because of a Karma

carried over from his previous life. He had stabbed a person in the stomach, then!

I came across many such incidents and it was an education for me.

Once, a Meditator took me to his house for a cup of tea. After going there, he told me that one of his relatives had committed suicide and his spirit was staying in the house. Although the spirit had not harmed anyone, my student felt that the spirit should be moved away from the house. I prayed to Amara. In a few seconds, a Rishi came there astrally and spoke to the spirit. The spirit agreed to accompany the Rishi to the place where all the dead go, rest and get guided for further journey in light. But the spirit wanted to stay there for one more day!

There was an elderly man living in the house. He was able to communicate with the spirit. They must have been talking to each other all these years. After some time, he came to me and asked me not to send the spirit away! I explained to him the necessity of everyone following the laws of birth and death and that I had not come there to interfere with or disturb anyone. He was not convinced and was not happy. But now, the spirit wanted to go. It accompanied the Rishi, the next day.

A student wanted a proof of the existence of the Rishis. He wanted an experience as a proof. I asked him to pray to the Rishis. After a week, he came running in excitement. When he had been meditating in the morning, he found that the bright light in the room was disturbing him. He wanted to close his eyes. When he tried, he realised that he had already closed his eyes! He was seeing the light within! He wanted to know if this was the proof. I said: "If not this, what else!"

One of my friends who had joined our group as a trustee, came to my village suddenly, one day. At that time, we were trying to hold a conference. We wanted a lot of money and there was not much time to collect. But I was confident. My friend wanted an indication about the Rishis helping us. We prayed to the Rishis. In the afternoon, there was a downpour, although it was January and not the season for rains. My friend realised that it was the sign from the Rishis, even without my indicating. He was overwhelmed to see that the rains had come down only around the village and nowhere else!

I recall an incident similar to this relating to Amara. One day, Amara, when he was a boy, was walking along with his friends near the present Fraser Town. His friends, having heard about his contacts with the Rishis, wanted him to bring rains at that time. And they got the rains! Amara had explained to us:

"As I was walking and talking with them, I went to Varuna Loka and requested the rain god to bring rains. Varuna Deva agreed and said that he would send a heavy downpour in about an hour's time. Then, I hurried my friends to reach their homes before the hour. They, of course, laughed at me. But it rained cats and dogs in an hour!"

Many such incidents and experiences come to my mind. They are too many and recording all of them is not the purpose of this book.

While trying to recall my life spent in those years, I am trying to convey, though not unconsciously, that there is another plane of existence and those living in that plane can influence, guide and help our life here, to a great extent. There is life beyond death. Our affairs do not end with this life. If we do not mend ourselves, do not

sublimate our thoughts and emotions and do not transform ourselves, we cannot get out of the track of pain and suffering even in the next or any number of lives. And there is so much that lies beyond the grasp of our reason.

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I have to mention one or two amazing incidents during this period.

One of my friends had joined the Meditation classes. After the first phase, he was about to take up Samadhi Yoga. He asked me if liquor and non-vegetarian food were to be avoided by the Meditators. At no time, had we laid down any restrictions on food and habits. But we had always cautioned that these would come in the way of expanding our consciousness, when we take up the practice of Samadhi Yoga. Putting it jocularly, it was either Samadhi or booze! My friend chose the latter. Then, he could not meditate even for a few moments and gave up Meditations.

My friend's wife was a clairvoyant. She had not visited my village but had described every detail of my room, the hut and the well to my friend. She had also mentioned about a snake living near my room! When I had explained to her about the snake that I had come across, she had said that there was another one!

Once, she came to our village along with my friend. When all the three of us were sitting for Meditation, she woke up to say that the snake was there! We could not see any snake. But she insisted it was there, in front of us! I could not understand much of it at that time. But now, I realise that she had seen an Astral snake. I came across many Astral snakes and persons, later on. Even now, as I take my first turn after my village, on my two wheeler, I come across an Astral snake which will be waiting for me. It means no harm. It is friendly.

Once, I and my worker had to go to a nearby town on some work. We started our journey on my moped. On the mid-way the petrol got exhausted. There was a petrol bunk nearby. We pushed the vehicle just for a few feet and reached it. But there was no petrol there. We were told that the next petrol bunk was ten kilometres away. We did not know what to do and went on pushing the vehicle. After a few yards, we came to a slope. So, both of us sat on the vehicle and allowed it to run down the long slope. Then, accidentally, I started the engine and it did not stop till we reached the petrol bunk, ten kilometres away. We had travelled ten kilometres without petrol! I recalled at that time that Amara had travelled once in his car, without petrol, for more than two hundred kilometres during one of his works for the Rishis.

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I knew that I had to give back the land to the villager some day. I searched for a place to stay near Manovati. There was another village, Chikkagubbi, much nearer to Manovati. I purchased a site there.

There were very heavy rains in 1991. The wall of the well collapsed. Again, a lot of money was required to repair the well. I decided to give back the land and start building a room to live in the site near Chikkagubbi. I had to arrange money. I wanted some time. Then, I shifted to a rented room in Bangalore for some time.

There, I wrote two small books about Meditation and Spiritual Science. There were invitations to visit America on a lecture tour. I was not tempted to accept them. I thought that I must prepare myself more and besides, my work was centred around Manovati. I had a lot of work.

I had completed another phase in my Sadhana. Amara wanted

to initiate me into the next stage. At that time, I wanted to wear the saffron dress. Amara gave me permission. I enjoyed people calling me a swami. But after some time, the fascination wore off. I could no more merge with the crowds without attracting attention. People stared at me in the book stores and libraries. I could not eat the roadside pani-poori and admire the vendor's efficiency in attending to several people simultaneously. I could not go to the fast food centres and while sipping hot coffee from the broken porcelain cups, watch people gobbling food in an endless hurry. The saffron gave me an aura but kept me away from the sea of humanity.

My childish saffron whim withered out soon. Amara laughed. He said: "The saffron should be worn inside." I waited for another initiation when I was permitted to revert back.

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A small house was coming up in the site that I had purchased near Chikkagubbi. It was again at a distance from the village; aloof. Before purchasing this site, a well-wisher had wanted to help me in acquiring two acres of land near another village. I wanted a bigger area than the site but I wanted it nearer Manovati. He could not understand that I wanted to live within the radius of the Manovati light. He was not happy.

One day, while meditating, I had a vision. In the vision, I saw the site and also a huge platform slightly away from it. More than a hundred young people were sitting in a very orderly way in a Yogic posture. A person was addressing them. It looked like a Gurukula class. The person looked familiar. His face..... Yes, it looked like my face! It was I. I remembered Amara telling me: "You were here in the last cycle, fifty-one thousand years ago. You started this work."

I knew, I had chosen the right place to live and work.

Everything was going on well. Then I became complacent for a while. I neglected my Sadhana. Then, I made mistakes. I could have avoided them. This forced me to introspect. Once, I spent an entire night reviewing my life, Sadhana and work. I realised that I was wasting my time in Bangalore when so much of work was waiting at Taponagara, our new place near Chikkagubbi.

One night, Amara came and pushed me into Samadhi. I experienced Samadhi for hours. This experience re-oriented my life thoroughly.

I moved to Taponagara in mid-1993.

FIVE

1993-1995

Taponagara is a small township near Chikkagubbi village which is twenty kilometres away from Bangalore. Buses from the city stop here. It is neither far nor near the bazaar to buy provisions and vegetables. There is electricity and a primary school for the village children, who are crammed in a single room and try the patience of the teacher who has to shout more than to teach. The telephone facility is only the latest luxury, which disturbs our peace more than it helps. But, I think, such gifts from civilisation have to be accepted even with their negative impacts. We have no choice.

The Rishis named this place as Taponagara, where the prime activity is Tapas; Meditation. In spite of the nearness to the urban life, Taponagara is full of peace and serenity. It is a place chosen for Tapas. Amara had told us that in the previous cycle of Yugas, Taponagara was a part of Bangalore. People from Bangalore used to come here to cleanse their mind. Even in the previous cycle, special energies from Brahma Loka were stored here by the Rishis to mainly cleanse the mind. Even then, the Sapta Rishis had opened their Centre here to disseminate higher Spiritual knowledge, required for the New Age.

Amara had told us that the earth would slowly tilt by two degrees in future. This would cause the northern ice cap to melt. Himalayas would drown under a sea. The sea would cover the

entire north India. Then the Divine essence associated with the rivers Ganga, Yamuna and Saraswati would be shifted to the south; to Taponagara. Taponagara would be the future Triveni Sangama.

A University of Spiritual sciences would come up in future. The Rishis would take birth and gather here. Kripacharya would shift his Gurukula to this place in the first part of the twenty-first century. Lord Kalki would visit Taponagara physically, after completing His work, before settling down in the Himalayas, in a place already chosen and prepared by the Rishis.

Amara had revealed much more about Taponagara which is not just the place that we are living in now or only the small township that is coming up here, but an area of about one and a half kilometres' radius encircling our place, which includes Manovati and three villages.

We have built up a very strong Spiritual field here now, working from 1993, which is like a huge globe. The Rishis have named this as the Manasi field. They have brought a deity to preside over this field and have named her, Manasi Devi. Energies from different planes have been gathered here by our Rishis and the special Rishis who periodically come from other Lokas. And the energies from Shambala have been brought here to build up conditions for establishing another Shambala.

Taponagara will be the land of Tapas and a guiding Light for the new Yuga.

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Before shifting to Taponagara from Bangalore, I had an interesting experience. I used to conduct Meditation classes for a small group of people. In the last class I held for them, I suddenly

sensed the presence of an Astral being. I put all my sensitivity into top gear found out that the visitor was Tara Devi from Shambala! She blessed us and went away. There was a Meditator who had a developed psychic sight. She also had seen Tara Devi.

The Meditator had one more experience to narrate. During the Meditation, she had opened her eyes briefly, for a moment. Then she was shocked; she could not see me who was sitting right in front of her! But after the Meditation, she could see me. Amara explained to me, later on, that the Astral visitor was sitting in front of me and had covered me. That is why the Meditator could not see me!

After three days of Tara Devi's visit, a person presented me with a statue of Tara Devi, which he had brought from Nepal. I knew it was not a coincidence and it had a message for me.

I requested a senior student to conduct Meditation Classes at the Bangalore centres. She took up the job with much devotion and sincerity. A few others assisted her. The Rishis helped her. And now, after more than four years, a very efficient group is doing a commendable work and I do not have to worry, "Who will continue the work of spreading the Knowledge from my Guru and the Rishis, after me?"

In Taponagara, I got a small house built up. I built a Meditation Hall also. And started Meditation Classes in Taponagara from January 1994. People began visiting Taponagara for the Classes, for Spiritual guidance and for just meditating for long hours. Taponagara became alive.

Amara took over my life completely. He guided me in every detail. He visited every class in Taponagara and at the Bangalore centres. He brought special Rishis from other earths who

performed Homas and Yagnas in the Astral plane and strengthened the Spiritual field.

As the years rolled on, Astral visitors from other parts of the world made frequent journeys to this place. Whenever the Rishis brought down the Divine personalities to this earth, they came here first, got the whole place and work blessed and then moved on to the Himalayas for their formal meetings. Astral Meditators began attending the Sunday classes in Taponagara, to be present with the presiding Rishis and to meditate along with our students. Many light workers from other parts of the world began visiting Taponagara for guidance from the Rishis and very shortly, Taponagara became the centre for a great Spiritual activity, after the Himalayan Centre.

On November 24, 1993, Vishwamitra Maharshi contacted me from another galaxy, for the first time in Taponagara and promised me to visit us on the Christmas day. When the Maharshi came, Amara was waiting to receive him. I had not seen Amara being so happy at any other time. Vishwamitra Maharshi was also very happy. He assured us that he would bring help from all corners of the universe to build up Taponagara. After a few days, he brought eighteen Rishis from Satya Loka for a special Yagna. He brought special Rishis on all the eclipse days to conduct special Homas and Yagnas. He has been the Light behind all the work that is going on at Taponagara, since then.

During this period, there were two specific invitations to me from America, to address conferences and for lecture tours. I was not enthused and Amara said: "No; not now."

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On November 19, 1993, a lady student joined us to work under

Jyoti project, which I had started with great enthusiasm to help the school children in their school studies and to groom their personality. We began teaching them hygiene, songs, painting and also Meditation. The children meditated better than the adults! One of them had special psychic insight. She could see Amara and other Astral visitors!

The lady who joined us had amazing psychic capabilities that we did not take much time to recognise. She could see the Astral beings and the Astral worlds with her eyes open. She could easily link up to the Rishis. She could gather energies from other planes. The Rishis tested her and took an assurance from her that she would work for them and then trained her systematically to assist in their works relating to Taponagara, over a period of months. She was named Ganga.

Ganga became popular with her remarkable visionary faculties. She could see a kidney stone, an Astral snake and the Divine personalities who visited us. People were stunned at her descriptions of the Divine forms. She became the darling of our Meditators and the Rishis.

Psychic capabilities are different from Spiritual growth. Whenever she faltered, the Rishis guided her with their natural kindness and love. Once, when she lost all her faculties when she made a mistake, Vishwamitra Maharshi restored all the faculties. When she was wavering in choosing her future, Bhriгу Maharshi told her: "Your future is with us. Stay here and die here."

Ganga could also see me astrally. She witnessed my Astral work. And inspite of my strict instructions, she used to spill out some information. People used to surround her, many times, to gather information about me and the Rishis.

After my return to Taponagara from the outside world in 1993, many doors in me opened suddenly. Many things were revealed to me. I realised that all the life I had spent outside Taponagara was not a waste but preparatory. I had spent more than fifty years outside!

On January 23, 1994, when I was meditating I had a strange revelation that I was a Rishi! After the Meditation, I admonished myself for such a presumption and allowing wild imagination to play. For days, whenever the idea neared me, I tossed it out of my mind and when it persisted, I ignored it.

On February 22, 1994, Amara and the Sapta Rishis came to my Meditation room astrally. There were two more visitors along with them. They were my parents who had left their bodies years ago! There was also a Divine personality - Lord Krishna!

I was told that the revelation I had had was true. I was shown a vision. In Satya Loka, in a cave completely covered by rocks, I was sitting in Tapas. I was told that I was there, even now, and that only a part of me was here. My name was Alaka. I was shown many other visions. I cannot mention them. I do not know if it is right or wrong that I write about my revelation here, which I had not spoken to anyone. Only Ganga knew; because she saw everything!

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The period, that is, 1993 onwards, was full of very unusual events such as in fairy tales! Recording them would require another voluminous book. I realise now that they are not to be recorded; not all of them. I mention here only one, not because it is extraordinary but because it reveals a truth.

I have a close friend whom I visit occasionally. His mother had passed away some years ago. Once, when I was with him, his mother came in contact with me, suddenly. She told me that she had taken permission from the Rishis and she wanted to convey something to her son. I hesitated for some time and then told my friend about the contact. He was eager to hear, although he had tears of memory and love welling up in his eyes. His mother said that she had misread him in many ways and was misled by others in the family when she was alive. She had done a great injustice to him. Now, she could see things clearly. She was sorry.

After a pause, my friend asked her if he could sell a site in his native place. Then came the unexpected reply: "I am not interested in all this. It is your decision. Once we leave our bodies, we are entirely different."

With the death of the body, all relations with the body also die. We do not realise this. The soul enters into another track; another orientation.

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On January 16, 1994 I was explaining a point in the Class at Taponagara. Suddenly, I saw a huge brilliance. It was like a sunrise in the Meditation hall. A form emerged out of the light. It was Mahavatara! He looked like a boy.

He gestured to me to continue and moved among Meditator students. He passed on light to everyone there and to me. Then He smiled and disappeared. Ganga, sitting among the students, witnessed all this.

It was a great day and moment. Taponagara was specially blessed.

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On December 25, 1993 we worshipped Christ. There were hundreds of Rishis and Astral visitors. When Christ appeared, it was like hundreds of suns appearing together. He descended down into my Meditation Room as a huge golden cross and then took the human form. He accepted our worship in the form of energies that we had lovingly gathered earlier, and accepted our love, beaming like a father. He addressed different groups that had come from different parts of the world. He gave us special instructions about our work.

At that time, another person was trying to establish contact with Christ. It was the deity, the goddess, who was taking care of the light that was brought down from the higher planes by the Rishis in 1982 and kept under Manovati! She wanted to assist the Rishis in their work here. Christ gave her instructions.

In the evening when I was sitting alone in my room, Amara contacted me from another galaxy. He could not join us earlier in the day when Christ visited us because he could not complete his work there in that galaxy, the Andromaeda galaxy. He knew about the Manovati Devi contacting us. He was happy and gave me permission to accept her help but instructed me not to go back to Manovati, when called back!

Recently, there was a suggestion from Mrs. Amara to involve myself again with the development of Manovati. I remembered Amara's words, not to go back.

I had not asked Amara the reason for my removal from Manovati at any time. He had not explained it either. As long as he was with me nothing else mattered. I had asked him once:

"Are you in touch with the others?"

Amara had replied:

"Yes."

I had not asked who were those with whom he was in contact. It was not important. I also knew that he would be guiding people at different levels and for different purposes. I was happy with my contact and with my work.

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February 1, 1994 was Amara's birthday. All our students gathered and meditated specially on that day. That was how we celebrated any special occasion in Taponagara; by special Meditations.

Lord Kalki was our special guest. The Rishis offered Him special energies as worship and presented Him with some special gadgets. At that time, an Astral gadget was fixed in my system also. I was instructed to report to Lord Kalki every night to work under Him in releasing the Pralaya energies. As the work progressed, many gadgets were attached to me during these three years.

These gadgets were not placed in my Astral body but in my Causal body which is subtler. It was always possible that my Astral body or the gadgets placed in the Astral body could get damaged. But no one, except the Rishis, could touch them at the Causal level.

The Astral works that I participated in, with the Rishis, are many. When I wake up the next day, sometimes, I do recall all the details. But most of the time, they are not allowed to be recalled. The memories are erased by the Rishis and whatever is relevant to my work at the physical level is allowed to surface. Even when the memories remain in my conscious mind, I do not speak about them or record them anywhere.

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During March 1994, a group of Rishis from Tapo Loka came and stayed for several days to build many tunnels or passages to other dimensions from this point. It saved us a lot of time and also gave us protection during the travel. Only Ganga knows about these. And also Soluntra, with her extraordinary faculties.

During March 1994, the Rishis conducted experiments about Kundalini with Ganga. She was asked to repeat a Mantra and allow her Kundalini to rise. The Rishis monitored the rise and asked me to record the effects. The experiments continued for about twenty days. Each day, the Kundalini rose higher and with more intensity. Ganga felt pain and discomfort. Sometimes she also felt Bliss and powers gathering in her. The Rishis removed the powers and placed them under the ground. They also removed the pain.

The experiment was stopped because her body could not withstand the expansion. The Rishis gave a lot of information about the Kundalini which is of great value and help to future Yogis. I have to continue with the experiment and then write about the Kundalini, later on.

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On September 9, 1994, there was a big function at the Astral level where the Sapta Rishis and many other Rishis were present. At the end of the function, I was instructed to stand in the midst of a fire and take an oath. I took the oath that I would work under the Rishis forever and work for the welfare of all. I would never use the powers that I have and may get in future for my personal gain. Then, Amara declared that I was promoted to a high rank in Rishihood.

From then on, I began training Meditators and other Light workers in the Astral works, taking them to Shambala, sometimes. I began attending to the works of distributing energies on this earth after bringing them from the Divine planes, independently. I took up many independent assignments.

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On November 30, 1994, Lord Krishna appeared on my Astral screen and told me: "You have only three years to live."

SIX

1995-1997

I spoke about my short life ahead in the classes and wrote about it in the Newsletter, issue after issue. People outside expressed concern in their letters and on the phone. They wanted to know how they could help me. I explained to them the importance of keeping the egos in check and developing tolerance, accommodation and the spirit of forgiving others.

The Rishis conducted Astral classes. Many students accepted the advice from the Rishis, made very sincere efforts to grow and reached higher states in Sadhana. But some who were actively involved in our work did not respond. That was a shock to me.

I had seen the ruination of peace and happiness in families, breaking up of groups and tumbling down of organisations with the devilish play of egos. But I had not expected this with the people around me. They did not listen to me. They did not listen to the Rishis. They listened only to the sweet voice of their egos. I tried in vain to educate them. They took one step forward and many steps backward.

I had witnessed the abandoning of a great Spiritual project in Manovati because of ego problems. I did not want a repetition here. The Rishis were unhappy. I spent sleepless nights and tried to correct the individuals but failed. I gave up my attempts to transform them and withdrew into my shell of loneliness, hoping

that someday, they would grow and would not spoil the work. I decided not to expand now; not to open more centres for teaching Meditation.

In a group meeting, one day, a person created a scene. The Rishi who was present at the meeting asked me to disband the group. Ganga walked out of Taponagara on December 18, 1997. The Rishis removed the Astral gadgets attached to her and severed their contacts.

Several Meditators had told me, months ago, about the visions they had had. They had seen the people around me quarrelling and fighting for their supremacy after my death. But I saw these things happening right in front of me, while still remaining in this body. I wondered many times - was it my softness or goodness that was being taken lightly or was it simply the egos?

These realities do pain me. But they do not discourage me in any way. My hope in a better tomorrow is untouched. I am not foolish in keeping the hope alive. I am not merely optimistic. I am aware that the Rishis will not allow their work to get disturbed every time. They will protect the work and take care that it grows.

I feel that we should not get anything easily. We will not value them. The Rishis gave a lot of knowledge and a big push in Sadhana, very easily. Maybe, people should have struggled to learn! I do not know.

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I have many wonderful students. Each one of these shine like a lamp. Some have experienced the higher states of Samadhi, which is not an easy accomplishment. The Rishis always help the sincere and the faithful. I want to mention some instances of their help which will help understand the workings of the Rishis.

A student in Samadhi Yoga was facing difficulties in Meditation. She could not make an inch of progress for some time. The Rishis examined the case and found that she had incurred the displeasure of her guru in one of her previous lives. The guru had not cursed her. But his displeasure was enough to affect her Spiritual progress beyond a point, in this life. The Rishis found out that the guru was doing Tapas in another Loka. They took her there. They contacted him at a very deeper level and explained her problem. He was a very great man. He had never known that his displeasure had caused an obstruction. Immediately, he came out of his Samadhi state and by his Tapas Shakti removed her obstruction and blessed her. And she could easily meditate afterwards and make progress fast!

A young girl had serious health problems. She was hospitalised. When the Rishis contacted her, she expressed her readiness to leave the body. But she still had a long life span with pain and suffering never giving her a respite. The Rishis went to the place where the people who decide about life and death work. They met the authorities and the concerned Divine being. They took permission for her to leave that body which was much ravaged by diseases.

The young girl died in the hospital. I had a vision of her leaving the body. She came out of her body sitting in Padmasana! The Rishis helped her to take birth again, after burning out her Karmas, to avoid repetition of the sickness and suffering in her next life.

A student used to complain often of severe headaches. All medicines had failed him. The Rishis examined him and found out that an Astral snake was giving him the headaches. He had killed that snake in his previous life without any provocation and in a

very painful way. When the Rishis spoke to the snake, it was not willing to give up torturing him. The Rishis promised to take it to her Loka and help in its Mukti. Then, the snake agreed and left him. He did not have headaches, any more.

The last instance of a killer ghost is an interesting case. A person who had met with a premature death in unhappy circumstances had become a killer ghost. He had caused several deaths in the family. The members of his family had dreams where he had threatened to wipe out the entire family. They were naturally scared. My student was one of the family members.

The Rishis contacted the ghost and asked him not to cause harm to anyone. He refused to listen to them and did not accept their help of guiding him to the proper place for the onward journey in life from there. The Rishis finally warned him that they would not allow any more killings and that they would punish him. He reluctantly left the place but did not join the Rishis. He said that he would join a dark group and would return to kill again!

There were no more deaths; no more nightmares. After a few months, there was a dream. The killer ghost appeared and said that he was now with the Sapta Rishis and that he was happy!

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My students had innumerable experiences. Meditators from other groups wondered about the experiences - their depth, frequency and the early occurrences. Having experiences is good. But they are not the end. They are not the goal. They are also not the measure. My students understood these clearly. They enjoyed the experiences but were not trapped in them.

In an innovative move, we gathered answers to two sets of questions about Meditations and Experiences and published two

books which contain a lot of material for research.

We formed a group called 'Light Channels'. Meditators in this group drew energies from the Cosmos and directed them to Taponagara. The energies were stored underground for the time being. The Rishis used these energies in their works and also in helping the students in their times of distress and need. The Energies drawn were not spread all over the world because they would interfere with the work of Pralaya.

Soluntra stayed with us in Taponagara during June 1995 and she transferred the energies that she had carried from Kashmir to a golden disc under the ground.

On August 25, 1997, the Samadhi of Amara, where I had kept his holy ashes that I had carried from Manovati, where his body was cremated, was filled with active energies. A fountain of energies was created by the Rishis. Meditators could always feel a living presence there. Whenever they took a question, they got an answer from the Samadhi. Whenever people took their problems, they found solutions easily.

On August 27, 1995 Bhishma visited Taponagara. He was very happy with us for continuing the Rishis' works. He blessed us and went away promising to return at an appropriate time.

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A snake goddess in a human body is very closely associated with the work of the Rishis from more than twenty years. With her special powers, she has often protected Rishis from the attacks of the dark people. She is guarding Taponagara. Once, when I was caught by some dark people during one of the works, she came rushing with such ferocity that they ran away leaving me behind!

I find that the Rishis have always helped her, even in minute details of her life. When she met with several accidents, the Rishis saved her from death, every time.

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In early 1997, I experienced a shooting pain in the heart region frequently. In May 1997, an Angiograph was taken where a block in the main artery was found. I was put on pills and strict diet.

In August 1997, the Rishis told me clearly that I would live only upto November 12, 1997. I did not speak about this to anyone and prepared myself for the day, leaving written instructions about the work in the future. But in October 1997, the Rishis told me that they had got my life extended. They did not tell me the number of days or years of the extended period. I did not ask them.

On December 24, 1997 I had a lot of pain and in the night I thought I was going to have a severe heart attack. My case papers were then taken to a surgeon who advised immediate surgery. I decided to get myself admitted to the hospital on January 2, 1998, after completing the writing of this book.

On December 27, 1997 I had two visions. One was of a black cross and the other was of an operation table with my dead body on it. I remembered the message from Lord Krishna three years ago, that I had only three years to live from that time. I realised that the time for leaving the body had finally arrived. Quickly, I prepared myself and waited.

The surgeon wanted to see the film of the Angiograph. When he saw the film, he found no block! He declared that I had no problem relating to the heart!

The Rishis did not explain about the disappearance of the block and the visions. When I asked them, they just smiled. The nearness to death put me on alert, gave me the human experiences relating to death and taught me the value of every moment I spend.

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On the night of December 24, 1997, I sat in Meditation to worship Christ. I saw a very huge star over the earth. Rays of golden yellow light were coming out of it and were entering the human beings all over the earth. I had not seen such a spectacle. It was glorious.

On December 25, 1997, Vishwamitra Maharshi came in link and said: "Note down. I will give you new techniques of Meditation for the New Age." I noted down for more than half an hour. He said: "You have to work hard in 1998. It will be a difficult year for everyone."

I meditated for a long time.

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Sitting alone in this room, I realise that the New Age will dawn soon. The Rishis are working for it. And we have to open up and rise without wasting time in pursuit of the unreal.

SEVEN

Most of us remain content with the Spiritual knowledge that we inherit from our elders and find in books, old and new. Only a few venture into the unknown to find answers for several questions about life and the truths behind it. If we do not try to find the answers, we die without knowing the basic realities.

More knowledge brings more sense. We will be able to deal with life in a sensible way; in the proper way. We live in peace and happiness. All knowledge helps this life; the present life; the immediate life that we are facing now. Without peace now, there will be no Moksha in the life after.

We must know about certain truths.

There was a life before this. There will be a life after this. We do not die with the physical body. We survive in our Astral bodies.

There are other planes; other dimensions. There are people living there like us; not the little green men of the science fiction. They are much more intelligent; much more civilised and much more advanced in all sciences. They are also very good, kind and loving. They can help us a lot in this and the next lives.

The Rishis are not just the characters in Puranas. They do exist. Some are here on this earth and many are in the higher planes. They are a part of a huge network of Light Beings who work under the Cosmic Intelligence. They can be contacted by anyone astrally and receive guidance and help.

Meditation is the first basic step in expanding our awareness. All other ways prepare us to take up Meditation which is the highest way. All Meditations lead to the experience of Samadhi. From this stage, all meditational ways merge into one way - the way of Samadhi. In Samadhi we expand our awareness to its cosmic limits. We experience God. This experience brings us the supreme knowledge. It brings us Peace of the highest order. It brings us wisdom and enormous strength to live in the light of the Truth. All negativities in us give way to positivities. Life becomes a very beautiful experience.

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Our work in Taponagara is to assist people in bringing out their Divine essence to the fore; to help people positivise their life and to guide them to the ultimate freedom, Mukti, after living a blissful life here.

In times of confusion, clear Spiritual guidance is available here.

This is a place for Tapas. One can find Light here easily. The Rishis, the Master Guides, guide anyone to Light. They are our Doorways to Light.



Our other Publications

Pyramid Revelations
Light Body and Other Realities
Experiences of Light Channels - Vol 1 & 2
Master-Pupil Talks
Quotes from the Rishis Vol 1 & 2
Higher Communication and Other Realities
New Age Realities
iGuruji - Vol 1 to 7
Channelled Knowledge from the Rishis -

Vol 1 to 4

How to Meditate
Dhyana Yoga
Descent of Soul
Practising Shambala Principles
Astral Ventures of A Modern Rishi
Guruji Speaks Part I & II
Guruji Speaks - Vol 3 to 7
The Book of Reflections - Vol 1 to 3
Living in the Light of My Guru
Meditators on Meditations
Meditators on Experiences
Meditational Experiences - Vol 1 & 2
Living in Light
Light
Awareness

ಬೆಳಕಿಗೆ ಬಾಗಿಲುಗಳು
ಬೆಳಕಿನ ಶರೀರ ಮತ್ತು ಇತರ ವಾಸ್ತವಗಳು
ಹೊಸಯುಗದ ವಾಸ್ತವಗಳು
ಉನ್ನತ ಸಂಪರ್ಕಗಳು
ಗುರು-ಶಿಷ್ಯರ ಸಂಭಾಷಣೆ
ಋಷಿಗಳಿಂದ ಬಂದ ಜ್ಞಾನ-ಭಾಗ 1 & 2
ಐ-ಗುರೂಜಿ-ಭಾಗ 1 & 2
ಅನಿಸಿಕೆಗಳು
ಧ್ಯಾನ ಮಾಡುವುದು ಹೇಗೆ
ಧ್ಯಾನ ಯೋಗ
ಆತ್ಮದ ಅವರೋಹಣ
ಶಂಬಲ ನಿಯಮಗಳ ಅಭ್ಯಾಸ
ಆಧುನಿಕ ಋಷಿಯೊಬ್ಬರ ಅತೀಂದ್ರಿಯ ಸಾಹಸಗಳು
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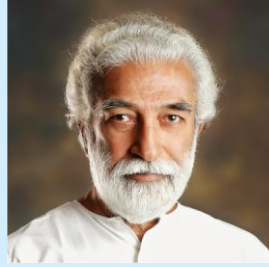
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ದೈವಸಾಕ್ಷಾತ್ಕಾರಕ್ಕೆ ರಾಮಕೃಷ್ಣರ ಮಾರ್ಗದರ್ಶನ
ಕಾವ್ಯಕಂಠ ವಸಿಷ್ಠ ಗಣಪತಿ ಮುನಿಗಳು

ಪ್ರಕಾಶವಾಟ್ (Marathi)
ऋषींकडून मिळालेले ज्ञान
गुरु-शिष्य संवाद
उच्चस्तरीय संवाद आणि इतर सत्ये
आयुर्गुरुजी
ध्यान कसे करावे
ध्यानयोग
आत्म्याचे पृथ्वीवर अवतरण
शंबला तत्वांचा अभ्यास
एका आधुनिक ऋषीचे सूक्ष्मजगातील पराक्रम
प्रकाशमय जीवन
प्रकाश

प्रकाश की ओर (Hindi)
ध्यान कैसे करे
ध्यानयोग
आत्मा का अवतरण
प्रकाशमय जीवन
प्रकाश

ಓಣಿಯಿನ್ ವಾಯಿಲೆಕನ್
ತ್ಯಾನ ಯೋಕಾ
ಆತ್ಮಮಾವಿನ್ ಅವರೋಹಣಂ
ಞಂಪಲಾ ನಿಯಮಂಗಳಿನ್
ಅಭ್ಯಾಸಂಗಳು
ನವೀನ್ ರಿಷಿ ಓಠುವರಿನ್ ಕೃಷ್ಣಂ
ಸಾಹಸಂಗಳು

ಓಣಿ
ಕಾಂತಿ ದ್ವಾರಾ
ಗುರುಸಂಗತ್ಯಂ
ಧ್ಯಾನಂ ಚಿಯ್ಯಡಂ ಎಲಾ



GURUJI KRISHNANANDA
(1939 - 2012)

Conversant with Puranas from childhood, he grew up with literature, painting and music. He met his Guru, Maharshi Amara, in 1977 and joined his work in 1981. He systematized the knowledge received from his Guru and developed it into Sapta Rishis Path. He channelled new Knowledge and enriched the Path.

He established Manasa Foundation (R) in 1988. He established the central Meditation Centre in Manasa in 1993 and a Study Centre in Antar-Manasa in 2006. He taught Meditation as taught by the Sapta Rishis to thousands of aspirants.

Manasa continues to disseminate the knowledge brought down by him and guide meditators based on his teachings.

"This Book is about my Guru, Amara. But an essential part of my life is also intertwined here. And also that of those Light Beings in the higher planes, known to us as the Rishis.

This is more about the unknown life of the unseen lights."

—Guruji Krishnananda
(From 'A Note' in the book)